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CITY OF BERKELEY

BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL SPECIAL MEETING

SEPTEMBER 16, 2025

>> RECORDING IN PROGRESS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY, FOLKS. WE ARE GOING TO GET STARTED. THANK YOU FOR YOUR PATIENCE, I KNOW WE ARE STARTING ABOUT FIVE MINUTES LATE AND I WANT TO MAKE SURE THAT WE HAVE PLENTY OF TIME FOR CONVERSATION AND QUESTIONS, SO FOLKS, IF YOU COULD PLEASE QUIET DOWN? FOLKS IN THE FRONT, THANK YOU. SO I AM GOING TO CALL TO ORDER THIS SPECIAL MEETING OF THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL. TODAY IS TUESDAY SEPTEMBER 16THS 2025. CLERK CAN YOU PLEASE TAKE THE ROLE?

>> CITY CLERK: COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI.

>> R. KESARWANI: HERE.

>> CITY CLERK: TREGUB.

>> I. TREGUB: HERE.

>> CITY CLERK: TAPLIN.

>> T. TAPLIN: PRESENT.

>> CITY CLERK: O'KEEFE.

>> S. O'KEEFE: HERE.

>> CITY CLERK: MAYOR ISHII.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: HERE.

>> CITY CLERK: QUORUM IS PRESENT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: VERY GOOD, WE ARE GOING TO START WITH ITEM 1A. WE HAVE TWO ITEMS ON OUR ACTION CALENDAR. SO THAT FOLKS KNOW WE WILL HAVE A PRESENTATION FROM THE CITY MANAGER'S OFFICE LED BY PETER RADU, AND THEN WE WILL HAVE A PRESENTATION FROM OUR CITY AUDITOR. THAT WILL BE FOLLOWED BY PUBLIC COMMENT SO FOLKS KNOW WHAT THE FLOW IS IF YOU ARE HERE FOR PUBLIC COMMENT. QUESTION, MARK? ARE YOU OKAY?

>> YEAH.

>> MAYOR ISHII: ALRIGHT, THEY ARE GOING TO GET STARTED AND THEN WHENEVER YOU ARE READY, YOU CAN GO AHEAD AND START.

>> OKAY. THANK YOU MADAM MAYOR AND COUNCILMEMBERS. MY NAME IS PETER RADU FROM OUR NEIGHBORHOOD SERVICES DIVISION. I AM HAPPY TO BE HERE WITH YOU THIS AFTERNOON TO DISCUSS THE WORK THAT THE CITY OF BERKELEY DOES TO ADDRESS HOMELESSNESS. WITH ME HERE TO PRESENT THE DETAILS ARE JOSH JACOBS OUR HOMELESS SERVICES COORDINATOR IN NEIGHBORHOOD CIRCUMSTANCES AND FARIMAH BROWN, OUR HOUSING DEVELOPMENT SPECIALIST IN HHCS. A QUICK NOTE BEFORE WE GET STARTED, WHICH IS THAT WHILE OUR PRESENTATION TODAY WILL FOCUS ON AN OVERVIEW OF OUR HOMELESS SYSTEM, THE WORKSESSION REPORT WHICH WE ORIGINALLY SUBMITTED TO YOU BACK IN JULY AND RESUBMITTED FOR THIS AGENDA IS MORE EXPANSIVE AS WE TOOK THAT

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OPPORTUNITY TO RESPOND TO A NUMBER OF REFERRALS FROM THE CITY COUNCIL'S MAY 20TH, 2025 REFERRAL TO STAFF ON HOMELESSNESS. THIS INCLUDES AN OVERVIEW OF OUR SYSTEM PERFORMANCE WITH NEEDS AND GAPS AND GEOGRAPHIC EQUITY MAP WITH SERVICES AND THEIR LOCATIONS AND UPDATE ON THE CITY'S FISCAL POSITION AND LACK OF FUNDING. FOR LACK OF TIME TODAY, OUR PRESENTATION DOESN'T COVER ALL OF THESE AREAS, BUT WE WOULD BE MORE THAN HAPPY TO ANSWER ANY QUESTIONS YOU MAY HAVE ABOUT THEM. WITH THAT I WILL START SHARING MY SCREEN AND TURN THINGS OVER TO JOSH JACOBS.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON, MAYOR, CITY COUNCIL AND THE PUBLIC. CAN YOU HEAR ME? TODAY'S PRESENTATION WILL FOCUS ON HOW BERKELEY IS CONFRONTING HOMELESSNESS WITH BOTH COORDINATION AND COMPASSION BALANCING THE HUMAN REALTIES ON THE GROUND WITH THE FUNDING, STRATEGY AND INFRASTRUCTURE NEEDED TO RESPOND. AS YOU ALL HOMELESSNESS IN BERKELEY IS COMPLEX AND DEEPLY HUMAN AND SHAPED BY REGIONAL FORCES SUCH AS TRENDS AND RACIAL INEQUALITIES -- THROUGH COMPASSION BERKELEY IS ACTIVELY CONFRONTING THE CHALLENGE. TODAY'S PRESENTATION WILL WALK THROUGH WHAT WE ACCOMPLISHED AND WHERE WE ARE SEEING IMPACT AND RISK IF THERE ARE FIRES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: CAN YOU PULL THE MIC CLOSER SO YOU DON'T HAVE TO LEAN SO MUCH SO YOU CAN BE COMFORTABLE.

>> CAN'T HEAR YOU.

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>> WHAT'S THE PROBLEM? BERKELEY LIKE EVERY CITY IN THE REGION CONTINUES TO FACE A DEEPLY TROUBLING REALITY. MANY OF OUR NEIGHBORS LIVE OUTDOORS. WHILE WE MADE PROGRESS THE SCALE OF THE PROGRESS REMAINS STAGGERING. THAT SAID WE ARE SEEING SHIFTS IN THE RIGHT DIRECTION. IN THE MOST RECENT TIME COUNT MORE PEOPLE WERE SHELTERED INDOORS IN BERKELEY THAN ANY PREVIOUS YEAR. THAT'S A SIGNIFICANT MILESTONE AND PROOF OF THE IMPACT OF OUR LOCAL INVESTMENTS INTO LOW BARRIER NON-CONGREGATE INTERIM HOUSING. THE CHALLENGE -- UNTIL THE TREND SLOWS, WE WILL CONTINUE TO SEE PEOPLE LIVING ON OUR STREETS. WE KNOW WHO IS IMPACTED MOST. CLOSE TO 60% OF BERKELEY'S HOMELESS POPULATION IDENTIFIES AS BLACK DESPITE BLACK RESIDENTS MAKING UP 8% OF THE CITY OVERALL. WE ARE SEEING RISING RATES OF PERSONS WITH ACUTE DISABILITIES. SERVING THESE POPULATIONS AND MAINTAINING THE PROGRESS WE HAVE MADE REQUIRES A COORDINATOR RESPONSE ACROSS MULTIPLE SYSTEMS WITH THE SAME LOCAL FUNDING. THE PATH FORWARD REQUIRES SUSTAINED REGIONAL RESPONSE, BUT ALSO LOCAL ACTION, WHICH WE WILL WALK THROUGH IN THE COMING SLIDES. AS MENTIONED BERKELEY IS FACING A FISCAL CLIFF FOR SEVERAL HOMELESS RESOURCES. MANY OF THE PROGRAMS RESPONSIBLE FOR RECENT GAINS ARE RELIANT ON TEMPORARY STATE AND FEDERAL FUNDS. IF WE DON'T IDENTIFY NEW SOURCES OF SUPPORT, BERKELEY FACES THE REAL RISK OF REVERSING COURSE WITH MANY OF THE PEOPLE CURRENTLY SHELTERED AT

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RISK OF RETURNING TO THE STREETS. IF WE DON'T SECURE LONG STANDING FUNDING PROGRAMS WILL CLOSE. THE WORK AHEAD WILL REQUIRE HARD CHOICES, BUT ALSO CREATIVE SOLUTIONS AND CONTINUED INVESTMENTS IN THE PROGRAMS THAT HAVE PROVEN SUCCESSFUL. AND YET AMIDST ALL OF THESE CHALLENGES, WE HAVE MADE REMARKABLE PROGRESS. SINCE 2019 BERKELEY HAS SEEN A 40% DROP IN HOMELESSNESS. IT'S HUNDREDS OF PEOPLE WHO ARE NO LONGER LIVING ON THE STREETS. IT'S A RESULT OF COORDINATED OUTREACH, TARGETED INVESTMENTS AND PARTNERSHIPS ACROSS DEPARTMENTS AND COMMUNITY PROVIDERS. IT'S A SIGN THAT WHEN WE INVEST IN HOUSING AND SERVES THAT ADDRESS THE UNIQUE NEEDS OF OUR CHRONICALLY HOUSELESS RESIDENTS, PEOPLE WILL TAKE THE OPPORTUNITIES. WHEN WE OFFER SHELTERS, WE SEE ACCEPTANCE RATE OF 40%. WHEN WE OFFER LOW BARRIER NON-CONGREGATE SHELTER WE SEE THE NUMBER JUMP TO 80%. THAT'S THE AREA WHERE WE ARE SEEING THE LOSING OF FUNDING. LET'S TALK ABOUT OUR COORDINATION EFFORTS IN 2021 BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL DOMINATED A THREE-PRONG STRATEGY. THE STRATEGY HAS THREE STRATEGIC COMPONENTS, ONE PREVENTING HOMELESSNESS FROM HAPPENING IN THE FIRST PLACE, TWO CREATING INTERIM HOUSING, AND THREE LEVERAGE RESOURCES TO INCREASE PERMANENT HOUSING AND SERVICES. I AM NOW GOING TO PASS IT OVER TO -- TO WALK US THROUGH SOME OF THE MORE INTERVENTION IN MORE DETAIL.

>> THANKS, JOSH. THE KEY TO STOPPING HOMELESSNESS IS PREVENTING

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IT FROM HAPPENING IN THE FIRST PLACE.

>> LOUDER.

>> CAN YOU HEAR ME NOW?

>> MAYOR ISHII: I THINK YOUR MIC IS ON. I THINK YOU WILL JUST HAVE TO PROJECT A BIT MORE.

>> NOW CAN YOU HEAR ME? BETTER? OKAY. THE SEE TO STOPPING HOMELESSNESS IS PREVENTING IT FROM HAPPENING IN THE FIRST PLACE AND BERKELEY HAS MADE PREVENTION A PRIORITY. BETWEEN 2020 AND 205 SERVED 940 RENTER HOUSEHOLDS. THE TEAM HAS WORKED WITH HIGH-TECHNICAL ASSISTANCE TEAM TO REVIEW OUR POLICIES TO ENSURE THAT WE ARE ABLE TO SERVE AS MANY HOUSEHOLDS AS POSSIBLE. FISCAL YEAR '21 THROUGH FISCAL YEAR '24 RELIED HEAVILY ON THE FEDERAL COVID FUNDS, WHICH WERE FLEXIBLE AND HIGHER AND RESULTED IN SERVING MORE PEOPLE. HOWEVER, DUE TO ITS FLEXIBILITY LOCAL FUND 1982 MORE BENEFICIAL FOR THE HOUSING PROGRAM. IN 2022 THE COUNCIL PROVIDED A PILOT PROGRAM THAT PROVIDES FUNDS TO MOST AT RISK RESIDENTS. THE PILOT HAS SERVED OVER 50 HOUSEHOLDS AND HAS HELPED THEM REMAIN STABLY HOUSED. THE SUBSIDY PROVIDES A SAFETY NET FOR THOSE WHO ARE MOST LIKELY TO RETURN TO THE STREETS WITH ADDITIONAL FUNDING THE PROGRAM COULD BE EXPANDED IN THE FUTURE. THE PROGRAM SERVES HIGHEST RISK ELDERS AND DISABLED AND SINGLE HOUSEHOLDS WITH MINOR CHILDREN, THOSE BELOW 50% AREA MEDIAN INCOME. NEXT SLIDE, PLEASE. THIS SLIDE SHOWS THE EVICTION FILING

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RATES IN ALAMEDA COUNTY. WE WILL IMPRESS UPON YOU THROUGH GENEROUS FUNDING FROM OUR RESIDENTS BERKELEY MANAGED TO PREVENT HOMELESSNESS AT A GREATER RATE THAN THE NEIGHBORING CITIES. BERKELEY STOOD OUT IN THE COUNTY FOR STRONG TENANT PROTECTIONS. IN FACT, BERKELEY HAD THE LOWEST EVICTION RATE OF ANY CITY FOR THE COUNTY AND THAT HAS A LOT TO DO WITH THE EXTENDED EVICTION MORATORIUM PASSED BY THE CITY COUNCIL. IN 2024 FOR EVERY 1,000 RENTER HOUSEHOLDS WHO CASED A COURT EVICTION FILING IN THE COUNTY, ON AVERAGE THERE WERE ABOUT 44 EVICTIONS AND BERKELEY'S RATE WAS BELOW THE COUNTY AVERAGE. COMPARED TO OTHER CITIES, WE ARE THE OUTLIER SUCCESS IN THIS CATEGORY. NEXT SLIDE, PLEASE. ANOTHER PART OF OUR COORDINATED EFFORT IS TO GETTING PEOPLE OFF THE STREETS AND INTO SAFETY AND SERVICES AS QUICKLY AS POSSIBLE. SOME OF THE LESSONS LEARNED DURING THE PANDEMIC WERE THE STRONG PREFERENCE PEOPLE EXPERIENCING HOMELESSNESS HAD FOR NON-CONGREGATE LOW BARRIER SHELTERS WITH ACCESSIBLE ROOMS. WE COMMITTED $37 MILLION IN LOCAL FUNDING APPROPRIATELY FROM MEASURES P AND U1. WE CREATED 164 UNITS OF INTERIM AND PERMANENT HOUSING. WHEN WE INVEST IN PERMANENT HOUSING, THE MORE ONGOING OF COSTS. THESE ARE THE MOST RESOURCE INTENSIVE. FOR PROJECTS, OUR EXPECTATION IS THAT DEVELOPERS WILL PURSUE OTHER OPERATING FUNDS INCLUDING THE COUNTY MEASURE W AND ALL THE RESOURCES ELIMINATED. THESE PERMANENT HOUSING UNITS WITH 54 YEARS OF

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RESTRICTION.

>> TO MEET THE GROWING NEED FOR SHELTER BEDS, BERKELEY HAS EXPANDED QUICKLY LEVERAGING BOTH PUBLIC FUNDS AND PRIVATE PARTNERSHIPS. WE FOUND PEOPLE EXPERIENCING HOMELESSNESS ARE FAR MORE LIKELY TO ACCEPT OUR OFFERS OF SHELTER IF WE PROVIDE THEM WITH PRIVACY AND INDIVIDUAL ROOM. WHILE MANY HAVE EXPERIENCED TRAUMATIZING INCIDENTS, WE ARE TRYING TO INCREASE THESE TYPES OF INTERVENTIONS AS MUCH AS POSSIBLE. FOR EXAMPLE, WE ARE ACTIVELY WORKING ON CONVERTING THE STAIR CENTER FROM CONGREGATE TO PRIVATE INTERIM SHELTER, BUT THE PASS OF INNOVATION MUST MATCH THE PACE OF NEED. AS MORE AND MORE PEOPLE LAND ON OUR STREETS AND MISS THE SHORTAGE OF SHELTER AND AFFORDABLE HOUSING, MANY OF THEM WIND UP IN THE ENCAMPMENTS. THESE ENCAMPMENTS WHILE BODY WORN OF NECESSITY POSE SERIOUS HEALTH AND SAFETY RISK BOTH TO THE PEOPLE LIVING IN THEM AS WELL AS THE SURROUNDING COMMUNITY. WE KNOW FROM RESEARCH LIVING OUTSIDE INCREASES ONE'S MORTALITY BY YEARS. IN 2021, THANKS TO AN ANNUAL INVESTMENT OF MEASURE P, THE CITY CREATED THE HOMELESS RESPONSE TEAM, WHICH BRINGS TOGETHER NEARLY ALL WINGS OF THE CITY GOVERNMENT TO ADDRESS AND CONNECT PEOPLE AND SERVICES, CLEANING UP THE DEBRIS AND WASTE THEY ACCUMULATE, PROVIDING BASIC HYGIENE THROUGH PORTA POTTIES AND WASH STATIONS, MITIGATING COMMUNITY IMPACTS AND IMPACTS ON CITY OPERATIONS AND INFRASTRUCTURE AND RESOLVING THE WORST

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HEALTH, SAFETY AND FIRE HAZARDS. UNLIKE MANY OTHER LOCALITIES HAVE BEGUN RUNNING A RACE TO THE BOTTOM THAT PRETENDS JAIL CELLS CAN SUBSTITUTE TO PERMANENT HOUSING BERKELEY REMAINS COMMITTED TO UPROOTING HOMELESSNESS AT ITS ROOT CAUSE. THAT'S WHY ENCAMPMENTS ARE ACCEPTED AND 2/3RD OF THE PEOPLE MOVED BY THE HOMELESSNESS RESPONSE TEAM MOVE INTO PERMANENT OR INTERIM HOUSING. THIS VISUAL DEPICTS THE IMPACT PRIVATE SHELTERS ARE HAVING WITH ENCAMPMENT RESIDENTS. 68% OF SHELTER PLACEMENTS MADE BY THE HRT WERE INTO PRIVATE ROOM SHELTERS. THIS REFLECTS THE INTENTIONAL STRATEGY TO RESOLVE NON-CONGREGATE BEDS FOR PEOPLE. BY MATCHING THE HARDER TO SERVE INDIVIDUALS WITH SHELTER MODELS THAT BETTER MEET THEIR NEEDS, WE ARE SUCCESSFULLY ENGAGING PEOPLE WHO PREVIOUSLY WERE UNSHELTERED AND MEANINGFULLY CHANGE THE DEMOGRAPHICS OF STREET HOMELESSNESSES IN BERKELEY. I AM GOING TO PASS IT BACK TO TALK THROUGH THE INVESTMENT SO FAR.
>> THANKS AGAIN TO BERKELEY RESIDENTS AND THE SUPPORT OF MEASURES O, P AND U1 BERKELEY HAS BEEN ABLE TO OPEN NEW PROJECTS INCLUDING NEW FACILITIES, WHICH INCLUDES TRANSITIONAL HOUSING SPECIFICALLY FOR OUR VETERANS. SINCE INCEPTION OF O, P AND U1 MORE THAN 70 INTERIM HOUSING BEDS AND PERMANENT UNITS HAVE BEEN FUNDED AND LEASED UP AND SERVED OVER 2100 RESIDENTS. THESE ARE NOT JUST NUMBERS, BUT THE PROJECTS CHANGE LIVES. THE IMPACT OF THESE LOCAL INVESTMENTS IS CLEAR -- MORE HOUSING, MORE SERVICES,

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MORE OUTCOMES. AS STATE AND FEDERAL SUPPORT BECOMES MORE UNCERTAIN, LOCAL FUNDING REMAINS THE BACKBONE OF OUR SYSTEM. NEXT SLIDE, PLEASE. ON AN EARLIER SLIDE, WE TALKED ABOUT BERKELEY'S COORDINATION STRATEGY, BUT WE CANNOT EXECUTE IT WITHOUT PROPER RESOURCES. BERKELEY RESIDENTS HAVE PROVIDED US WITH THE CRITICAL FUNDING NEEDED TO ADDRESS THIS PROBLEM THROUGH MEASURES P, U1 AND O. THIS SLIDE SHOWS 31% OF THE TOTAL FUNDS THAT BERKELEY PUT TO WORK PROGRAMS SERVING THE HOMELESSNESS WERE GENERATED BY MEASURE P. IT WAS APPROVED BY RESIDENTS IN 2018 AND IT'S THE LIFELINE AND BACKBONE THAT FUNDS THE CITY'S HOMELESSNESS. MEASURE U1 PASSED IN 2016 CREATES FUNDS FOR EVICTION DEFENSE TO KEEP OUR RESIDENTS HOUSE SAID AND CONTRIBUTES TO AFFORDABLE HOUSING PRODUCTION. NEXT SLIDE, PLEASE. BERKELEY HAS COMMITTED O FUNDING TO BUILD NEW UNITS ALONG WITH MEASURE U1. THIS MAP SHOWS PROJECTS FUNDED BY BOTH MEASURES AND THAT WERE COMPLETED WHICH IS SHOWED ON THE SLIDE IN GREEN AND THAT ARE IN PIPELINE SHOWED IN PURPLE. PERMANENT HOUSING UNITS INCLUDING PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING OR PSH. THE OCCUPYING NORTH BERKELEY BART PROJECT SHOWN IN PURPLE INCLUDES 85PHS UNITS. NEXT SLIDE, PLEASE. HAVING MORE PERMANENT AFFORDABLE HOUSING IS PART OF A COORDINATED STRATEGY. SINCE 2018 BERKELEY CREATED MEASURE O FUNDING TO BUILD THROUGH A 27 UNITS AND 44 SHELTER BEDS HAVE BEEN CONSTRUCTED. THE REMAINING UNITS

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ARE AT VARIOUS STAGES IN DEVELOPMENT OR IN PIPELINE AS WE SAW ON THE LAST SLIDE. THEY INCLUDE PSH PROJECTS. WITH THAT I WILL TURN IT BACK TO JOSH.

>> HERE'S WHERE THE URGENCY BECOMES MOST ACUTE. SOME OF OUR MOST CRITICAL PROGRAMS LIKE 24/7 SHELTER AND NON-CONGREGATE SITES AND HOME KEY HOUSING ARE LIMITED ON LONG-TERM FUNDING. THEY HAVE BEEN LIFELINES FOR SOME OF OUR MOST VULNERABLE RESIDENTS, ESPECIALLY SENIORS, THOSE WITH DISABILITIES AND THOSE WHO CAN'T ACCESS SHELTER. IF THAT FUNDING RUNS OUT, THE CONSEQUENCES WILL BE IMMEDIATE. AS YOU CAN SEE ON THE CHART BERKELEY FACES A FISCAL CLIFF OVER THE COMING YEARS WHEN IT COMES TO SUSTAINING THE SUCCESS. FIRST, WE FACE A STRUCTURAL DEFICIT ON OUR ANNUAL FUND OF OVER $20 MILLION ANNUALLY. IT WILL REQUIRE NEW REVENUES CUTS TO CITY SERVICES OR BOTH. MEASURE P IS PREDICTED TO RUN A $5.3 MILLION DEFICIT. OF NOTE, STAFF HAVE NOT BEEN ABLE TO QUANTIFY THE EFFECTS OF MEASURE W PASSED BY THE VOTERS IN NOVEMBER. THE HUGE AMOUNT OF STATE FUNDING IS SET TO BE EXPANDED THE COMING YEARS. THIS SLIDE SHOWS JUST A FEW OF THE PROGRAMS BERKELEY STANDS TO LOSE OR SIGNIFICANTLY REDUCE IN SCOPE OVER THE COMING YEARS. PUT SIMPLY, WE NEED TO COME UP WITH OVER $9 MILLION ANNUALLY TO KEEP THE LIGHTS ON IN THESE EXISTING PROGRAMS. OBVIOUSLY, THIS HAS SERIOUS IMPLICATIONS ON OUR ABILITY TO OPEN AND OPERATE NEW PROGRAMS. AS PRESENT, WE ARE NOT

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IN A POSITION TO OPEN ANY NEW PROGRAMS INVOLVES EXTERNAL FUNDING IS IDENTIFIED OR CURRENT PROGRAMS ARE CUT TO BALANCE THE DEFICIT. FINALLY, TO CONCLUDE OUR OVERVIEW I WOULD LIKE TO INTRODUCE YOU TO MILTON THOMAS. AFTER TEN YEARS OF LIVING OUTSIDE, HE HAS A PLACE TO CALL A HOME. HE NEEDED TO GET SET UP WITH BENEFITS AND MEDICAL SERVICES. HE NEEDED TO RECONNECT WITH HIS FAMILY, BUT HE DID IT. MR. THOMAS MOVED OUT OF THE HOME CENTER INTO A PERMANENT APARTMENT IN THE EAST BAY. TO QUOTE -- (READING) [REFERRING TO SLIDE]. AFTER LIVING OUTSIDE ON AND OFF FOR TEN YEARS, I HAVE PLACE OF MY OWN THAT I CAN CALL HOME. MR. THOMAS' STORY IS ONE OF MANY. WHAT MADE THE DIFFERENCE? A CONSISTENT, COMPASSIONATE TEAM AND A ROOM TO MOVE INTO. THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> THANK YOU, COUNCIL. THAT CONCLUDES OUR PRESENTATION. AGAIN, HAPPY TO ANSWER ANY QUESTIONS. HAPPY TO HAVE THE OPPORTUNITY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. I AM TRYING TO DECIDE IF WE SHOULD TAKE THESE QUESTIONS NOW OR IF WE SHOULD HAVE THE OTHER PRESENTATION FIRST? DO FOLKS HAVE ANY BURNING QUESTIONS? OTHERWISE, I CAN -- I THINK WE SHOULD DO THEM TOGETHER.

>> I HAVE ONE BURNING QUESTION.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY.

>> I APOLOGIZE FOR ARRIVING LATE, BUT I ARRIVED DURING THE SEGMENT ON PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING, I WONDER IF YOU COULD

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SPEAK TO OUR HOTEL BASE SHELTER PROGRAMS AND OUR HOME KEY PROGRAMS SUCCESSFUL?

>> WELL, I THINK WITH RESPECT TO HOME KEY THAT'S PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING AND WE HAVE KNOWN THROUGH DECADES OF RESEARCH THAT THAT IS THE MOST SUCCESSFUL WAY TO END HOMELESSNESS FOR, YOU KNOW, PEOPLE WHO ARE CHRONICALLY HOMELESS WITH 60S. SO I THINK WE KNEW GOING INTO THAT INTERVENTION THAT IT WAS SET UP FOR SUCCESS. WITH RESPECT TO THE NON-CONGREGATE INTERIM, THE SHELTER MOTELS THAT WE HAVE USED, I THINK IT REALLY COMES DOWN TO HAVING LOW BARRIERS, YES, BUT ADDING THE ADDITIONAL ELEMENT OF PRIVACY. HAVING THAT DIGNITY AND THAT SECURITY OF HAVING A CLOSEABLE DOOR AND HAVING YOUR OWN SPACE HAS BEEN VERY APPEALING WE FOUND TO PEOPLE ON THE STREET WHO MAY HAVE HAD BAD EXPERIENCES IN CONGREGATE TYPE SHELTER SETTINGS. THE DATA IS SHOWING FOLKS ARE VOTE, THEIR FEET. EVEN THOUGH WE ARE OFFERING BOTH, WE SAW IN THE SLIDES 2/3RD OF THE ENROLLMENTS ARE ACTUALLY INTO THE NON-CONGREGATE PROGRAMS.

>> THANK YOU VERY MUCH. AS A FOLLOW UP, IF WE WERE TO LOSE FUNDING AND PROTECT THE PROGRAMS, YOU MENTIONED THE TRADEOFFS AND THINGS WE WOULD HAVE TO CUT, AND I AM WONDERING HOW WE MIGHT CONSIDER THE BEST WAY TO THINK ABOUT THOSE QUESTIONS?

>> THAT'S AN EXCELLENT QUESTION. YOU KNOW, OBVIOUSLY THIS IS GOING TO BE AN IMPORTANT DISCUSSION BETWEEN STAFF, THE COUNCIL

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AND THE PUBLIC MOVING FORWARD AND SO I DON'T HAVE ALL THE ANSWERS RIGHT NOW HERE TODAY, BUT I THINK THERE IS A NUMBER OF THINGS THAT COME TO MIND. FIRST AND FOREMOST, I DO WANT TO STRESS WHILE THE FISCAL PICTURE THAT WE PAINTED HERE TODAY IS LARGELY NOT A ROSY ONE, WE ARE ACTIVELY ENGAGE SAID WITH THE COUNTY ABOUT DISCUSSIONS OF MEASURE W AND SALES TAX FUNDING AND FIRST IN LINE TO DRAW DOWN AS MUCH AS POSSIBLE. BACK IN JUNE WE SUBMITTED A LETTER TO THE COUNCIL THAT DETAILED OUR NEEDS AND PROJECTS THAT ARE SHOVEL READY TO GO. AND MYSELF AND JOSH ARE TABLE AT TABLES WITH THE COUNTY MAKING SURE WE ARE IN POSITION FOR THAT FUNDING. , YOU KNOW, IN TERMS OF WHETHER OR NOT THAT FUNDING CAN COVER EVERYTHING IS GOING TO BE AN OPEN QUESTION. IF NOT, OBVIOUSLY, WE ARE GOING TO HAVE A VERY DIFFICULT SERIES OF CHOICES AHEAD.

>> THANK YOU VERY MUCH.

>> MAYOR ISHII: AND YOU HAD ANOTHER BURNING QUESTION. COUNCILMEMBER.

>> C. LUNAPARRA: YES, THANK YOU VERY MUCH, MADAM MAYOR. THANK YOU FOR YOUR PRESENTATION. I THINK WE WAITED THE ENTIRE SUMMER RECESS TO HEAR FROM YOU. I WANT TO THANK YOU EARLY AND THANK YOU ALL THE WORK THAT'S BEING DONE EARLY TO ADDRESS UNSHELTERED HOMELESSNESS IN OUR COMMUNITY. I KNOW IT'S HARD WORK AND CAN BE THANKLESS AT TIMES. I DID WANT TO ASK YOU ABOUT COSTS BECAUSE

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THAT'S SOMETHING I TRY TO CONVEY TO MEMBERS OF THE COMMUNITY, YOU KNOW, THE COST OF THE MOTEL AND THE COST OF THE HOPE CENTER. I WANT TO ASK IT NOW BECAUSE I DON'T KNOW IF YOU HAVE THOSE NUMBERS HANDY OR IF THERE IS SOMETHING YOU COULD LOOK UP SO WE CAN GET A SENSE OF THE COST PER ROOM FOR THE HOME KEY MODEL, WHICH IS THE GOLDEN BEAR AND ROADWAY MOTELS AND THEN ALSO THE HOPE CENTER SO PEOPLE CAN HAVE A SENSE TO DO SOMETHING LIKE THAT FROM SCRATCH, TO BUILD NEW PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING BUILDING, WHAT DOES THAT LOOK LIKE? WE MENTIONED WE ARE PLANNING TO DO THAT AT NORTH BERKELEY BART AND AT PEOPLE'S PARK. I WANTED PEOPLE TO GET A SCALE OF THAT AND WHY IT'S SUCH A CHALLENGE TO GET THOSE OPEN BECAUSE OF THE COSTS. I DON'T EXPECT YOU TO HAVE IT AT YOUR FINGERTIPS, IF YOU COULD HAVE IT AT THE END, THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANKS. WE WILL HAVE THIS PRESENTATION FROM THE AUDITORS, AND THEN I THINK WE WILL PROBABLY HAVE ADDITIONAL QUESTIONS. THANK YOU.

>> THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU SO MUCH.

>> STAFF: CAN EVERYONE HEAR ME NOW? GREAT. GOOD AFTERNOON, AND THANK YOU SO MUCH FOR HAVING MY TEAM HERE WITH ME TODAY. I HAVE ERIN MULLEIN OUR AUDIT MANAGER WHO WAS ON THIS PROJECT, AND YOU HAVE NOW HEARD A PRESENTATION FROM THE CITY MANAGER'S OFFICE ON

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THE OVERVIEW OF THE CITY'S HOMELESS RESPONSE. WE ARE GOING TO BE PROVIDING A PRESENTATION ABOUT OUR AUDIT THAT WAS RELEASED IN JULY, SO IT'S BEEN A BIT OF TIME, BUT I AM HOPING TO GIVE YOU A GOOD OVERVIEW. SO IN THIS PRESENTATION, WE WILL LOOK AT WHY WE DID THIS AUDIT, OUR OBJECTIVES, FINDINGS AND RECOMMENDATIONS AND MANAGEMENT'S RESPONSE. AS YOU PROBABLY KNOW, OUR OFFICE CONDUCTS INDEPENDENT ANALYSIS OF CITY PROGRAMS AND SERVICES AND IDENTIFIES WAYS TO IMPROVE THEM. WE INITIATED THIS SPECIFIC AUDIT BECAUSE WE HEARD OF COMMUNITY CONCERNS OVER ENCAMPMENTS AND UNSHELTERED HOMELESSNESS. WE FOCUSED OUR AUDIT ON THE HRT BECAUSE IT IS AN IMPORTANT TOUCH POINT FOR ENCAMPMENT RESIDENTS IN BERKELEY AND A KEY COMPONENT TO THE CITY'S APPROACH IN ADDRESSING UNSHELTERED HOMELESSNESS. BEFORE I GET INTO OBJECTIVES, I JUST WANTED TO TAKE A QUICK MOMENT AND ACKNOWLEDGE THAT HOMELESSNESS IS A REAL TRAGEDY AND THE RESULT OF THE NATIONWIDE -- THE NATIONWIDE AFFORDABLE HOUSING CRISIS. AND IT WILL TAKE MORE THAN BERKELEY TO ADDRESS THIS. REGIONAL CONDITIONS AFFECT THE CITY'S ABILITY TO FULLY ADDRESS THIS AS MANY RESOURCES ARE SHARED REGIONALLY, AND MORE. SO WITH THAT, I WANTED TO SHARE OUR OBJECTIVES. THEY WERE TO DETERMINE WHAT THE ROLE THE HRT HAS IN RESPONDING TO ENCAMPMENTS, HOW THE HRT COORDINATES WITH OTHER ORGANIZATIONS TO RESPOND TO ENCAMPMENTS AND HOW THE HRT MEASURES DATA TO MEASURE PROGRESS TOWARDS GOAL

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AND HOW IS THIS COMMUNICATED TO THE PUBLIC AND DECISION MAKERS? OUR SCOPE PERIOD WAS BETWEEN 2022 AND 2024. I AM NOT GOING TO READ EVERYTHING WITH OUR METHODOLOGY, BUT WE EVALUATED A LOT OF DIFFERENT POLICIES, OPERATIONS DATA. WE COMPARED THIS TO OTHER BEST PRACTICES AND OTHER ORGANIZATIONS AND JURISDICTIONS AND WE INTERVIEWED A VARIETY OF FOLKS FROM CITY AND COUNTY OFFICIALS TO OUTREACH PROVIDERS, HOMELESS ADVOCATES AND OTHER STAKEHOLDERS TO UNDERSTAND THIS ISSUE. SO WHAT DID WE FIND? SO FIRST, THE HRT CONDUCTS OUTREACH AND ENFORCEMENT WITH LIMITED CITY AND COUNTY RESOURCES. SO WHAT DOES THAT MEAN? THE HRT WORKS IN PARTNERSHIP WITH OTHER CITY DEPARTMENTS AND DIVISIONS TO RESPOND TO ENCAMPMENTS OPERATING IN BOTH AN OUTREACH AND ENFORCEMENT ROLE. AS YOU CAN SEE IN THIS CHART, THE HRT PROVIDES A WIDE VARIETY OF ENCAMPMENT INTERVENTIONS. THE HRT SOMETIMES FACES CHALLENGES WITH THESE VARIOUS ENTITIES IN THE CITY OF BERKELEY COMMUNITY. WHILE IN ADVOCATES HAVE STATED THAT CLOSING ENCAMPMENTS CAN BE DESTABILIZING FOR RESIDENTS. THE HRT MUST NAVIGATE A PRETTY COMPLEX REGIONAL SYSTEM TO REFER PEOPLE TO SHELTER. MOST HOUSING AND RESOURCES ARE OVERSEEN BY THE ALAMEDA COUNTY CONTINUUM OF CARE OR THE COC, WHICH IS THE MAIN PLANNING BODY IN ALAMEDA COUNTY THAT ORGANIZES SERVICES FOR HOMELESS RESIDENTS. TO ACCESS RESOURCES THROUGH THE COC, INDIVIDUALS MUST COMPLETE A COORDINATED ENTRY ASSESSMENT. THESE ASSESSMENTS EVALUATE FACTORS

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LIKE AGE, HOMELESSNESS, HEALTH TO DEVELOP AN ASSESSMENT SCORE AND PRIORITIZE RESOURCES. INDIVIDUALS WHO MEET A CERTAIN THRESHOLD SCORE CAN BE PLACED INTO EITHER THE INTERIM HOUSING QUEUE FOR EMERGENCY SHELTERS OR TRANSITIONAL HOUSING OR THE PERMANENT HOUSING QUEUE. THE CITY'S PERMANENT HOUSING RESPONSE EXTENDS BEYOND THE HRT. THE HRT WORKS ALONGSIDE OTHER ORGANIZATIONS PROVIDING OUTREACH, INCLUDING CONTRACTING SERVICE PROVIDERS, ADDITIONAL ORGANIZATIONS PROVIDING SERVICES TO ANKLES. HRT CAN DIRECTLY REFER PEOPLE TO SHELTER BEDS MANAGED BY THE CITY, BUT SHELTER REFERRALS ENFORCED BY COUNTY RESOURCES MUST GO THROUGH THE COORDINATED ENTRY PROCESS. THERE ARE LIMITED SHELTER RESOURCES IN BERKELEY COMPARED TO THE NUMBER OF PEOPLE EXPERIENCING HOMELESSNESS. BERKELEY USES, I THINK, WE HAVE HEARD ABOUT THE PIT COUNT OR THE POINT IN TIME COUNT TO ESTIMATE THE HOMELESS POPULATION, WHICH OCCURS EVERY TWO YEARS. AS YOU HEARD PREVIOUSLY BERKELEY SAW A 45% REDUCTION BETWEEN 2022 AND 2024. DESPITE THAT REDUCTION, THERE ARE STILL NOT ENOUGH BEDS FOR PEOPLE WHO NEED THEM. THE 2024 PIT COUNT SHOWED THERE WERE 844 PEOPLE EXPERIENCING HOMELESSNESS IN EEOC ON ONE NIGHT IN JANUARY 2024. AND 445 OF THOSE PEOPLE WERE UNSHELTERED. IN AUGUST 2024, THERE WERE ONLY 320 SHELTER BUILDS IN BERKELEY, MEANING THERE WERE MORE THAN TWO TIMES AS MANY PEOPLE EXPERIENCING HOMELESSNESS ON ANY ONE NIGHT AS THERE WERE SHELTER

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BEDS IN BERKELEY. THE HRT ALSO DOES NOT CONTROL REFERRALS FOR THE MAJORITY OF SHELTER BEDS IN THE SYSTEM. IN AUGUST 2024, THE HRT COULD ONLY REFER INDIVIDUALS TO 56 OUT OF THE 320 SHELTER BEDS. THE OTHER 264 BEDS WERE REFERRED DIRECTLY THROUGH THE COC. I THINK IT'S THE NEXT -- IN ORDER TO ACCESS COC RESOURCES THERE MAY HAVE BEEN LONG WAIT TIMES. ACCORDING TO A TO ESTIMATES DURING THE AUDIT PERIOD, THERE WAS AN AVERAGE OF A 70-DAY WAITING PERIOD TO ACCESS EMERGENCY SHELTER AND NINE MONTHS TO ACCESS PERMANENT HOUSING. RESOURCE CONSTRAINTS WITHIN THE CITY ALSO IMPACT HRT'S ABILITY TO ADDRESS ENCAMPMENTS. THE HRT WORKS WITH OTHER DEPARTMENTS AND DIVISIONS WITHIN THE CITY TO RESPOND TO ANKLES AND RESOURCES OF AVAILABILITY LIKE STAFF AND EQUIPMENT CAN IMPACT THE HRT'S ABILITY TO CONDUCT ENCAMPMENT INTERVENTIONS. BERKELEY DOES NOT HAVE STAFF DEDICATED ADDRESSING ENCAMPMENTS. SINCE EQUIPMENT IS USED TO ADDRESS VARIOUS OPERATIONAL AND SERVICE NEEDS THROUGH THE CITY, THE AVAILABILITY OF EQUIPMENT LIKE A BACKHOE BEING USED FOR STREET REPAIR OR A VECTOR TRUCK BEING USED FOR SEWER LINE CLEANING, THIS CAN IMPACT ENCAMPMENT OPERATIONS. THE RISE IN ENCAMPMENT-RELATED LAWSUITS ALSO IMPACT STAFF TIME. THE HRT STATES THAT STAFF SPEND AN ESTIMATED 10 TO 15% OF THE WORK WEEK RESPONDING TO LEGAL ISSUES. THIS ALSO IMPACTS STAFF OUTSIDE OF THE HRT ACCORDING TO THE CITY ATTORNEY'S OFFICE, THEIR STAFF SPEND AN AVERAGE OF 10 TO 40

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HOURS A WEEK PER ATTORNEY RESPONDING TO ENCAMPMENT-RELATED LEGAL ISSUES. SO OUR SECOND FINDING IS THAT THE HRT PAUSED SOME COORDINATION MEETINGS THAT -- AND HAD LIMITED ACCESS TO SHARED INFORMATION SYSTEMS. WE OBSERVED SOME GAPS IN THE HRT'S COORDINATION WITH THIRD PARTY OUTREACH SERVICE PROVIDERS. THE HRT DECIDED TO PAUSE WEEKLY CASE CONFERENCE MEETINGS WITH SERVICE PROVIDERS FROM OCTOBER 2023 TO SEPTEMBER 2024 DUE TO LEGAL ACTIONS SURROUNDING ONE ENCAMPMENT. HOWEVER, DATA SHOWS ENCAMPMENT INTERVENTION TOOK PLACE IN OTHER SITES DURING THE PAUSE IN CASE CONFERENCES. ONE MEDICAL PROVIDER STATED THEY LOST TRACK OF THEIR CLIENTS AFTER THE CITY'S ENCAMPMENT ACTIONS DURING THE PAUSE IN CASE CONFERENCES. PROVIDERS, SUCH AS STREET MEDICINE TEAMS OR HARM REDUCTION WORKERS OFTEN HAVE KEY INSIGHTS THAT CAN IMPROVE SERVICE CONNECTIONS AND WHEN THESE PROVIDERS ARE NOT PART OF THE COORDINATION EFFORTS, IMPORTANT INFORMATION ABOUT RESIDENTS' NEEDS CAN BE MISSED. THOUGH THE CASE CONFERENCE MEETINGS HAVE SINCE RESUMED, THE HRT DID NOT HAVE WRITTEN PROCEDURES THAT COULD ENSURE CONTINUED COMMUNICATION WITH SERVICE PROVIDERS OR ANY FORMAL COORDINATION STRUCTURE DEFINING ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES. HRT ALSO HAD LIMITED ACCESS TO IMPORTANT SHARED INFORMATION SYSTEMS THROUGH THE COUNTY. DURING THE AUDIT PERIOD, HRT HAD LIMITED ACCESS TO THE HOMELESS MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEM OR HMIS, WHICH IS THE INFORMATION

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SYSTEM SHARED BY ALL PROVIDERS WITHIN ALAMEDA COUNTY, COC AND IS USED TO COLLECT CLIENT LEVEL DATA ON THE PROVISION OF HOUSING AND SERVICES. THE HRT DID NOT GAIN ACCESS TO HMIS UNTIL DECEMBER 2022. HRT INSTEAD STORED MOST OF THEIR DATA IN EXCEL SHEETS, WHICH WERE NOT READILY ACCESSIBLE TO OTHER PROVIDERS. WE OBSERVED SOME GAPS IN THE INTERNAL DATA THEY COLLECTED ON ENCAMPMENTS. ALAMEDA COUNTY ALSO DID NOT GRANT HRT THE ABILITY TO CONDUCT COORDINATED ENTRY ASSESSMENTS. SO THESE ARE THE ENTRY POINTS INTO THE ALAMEDA COUNTY SERVICES AND SHELTERS. THEY DIDN'T GET ACCESS TO THAT UNTIL ABOUT A YEAR AGO IN SEPTEMBER 2024. THE HRT THEREFORE COULD NOT TAKE THE FIRST STEP NEEDED TO CONNECT INDIVIDUALS TO COC SERVICES AND HAD TO RELY ON OTHER ORGANIZATIONS WITH COORDINATED ENTRY ACCESS TO THESE ASSESSMENTS. THIS COULD HAVE INCREASED WAIT TIMES FOR INDIVIDUALS TO SERVICES. ACCORDING TO THE HRT THEIR PERSISTENT ADVOCACY TO ALAMEDA COUNTY CONVINCED THE COUNTY TO GRANT THEM ACCESS TO THE DATA SYSTEMS. OUR THIRD FINDING IS THAT THE HRT CAN STRENGTHEN ITS APPROACH TO USING OUTCOMES FOR MEASURING PROGRESS TOWARD GOALS AS WELL AS KEEPING THE PUBLIC INFORMED. DURING THE AUDIT PERIOD OF TIME, THE HRT TRACKED SOME OUTCOMES RELATED TO THEIR GOALS. THEIR THREE GOALS WERE OUR RESIDENTS ARE SHELTERED, DANGEROUS ENCAMPMENTS ARE NOT INEVITABLE, AND OUR CITY IS CLEAN. AS YOU CAN SEE IN THE TABLE, THE HRT CONNECTED

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SOME OUTCOMES TO THOSE PROGRAM GOALS. FOR EXAMPLE, MEASURING THE PERCENTAGE OF PEOPLE CONNECTED TO SHELTER AS PART OF OUR RESIDENTS ARE SHELTERED OR MEASURING THE NUMBER OF ENCAMPMENT CLOSURES AS PART OF DANGEROUS ENCAMPMENTS ARE NOT INEVITABLE. MOST OF THESE MEASURES WERE REPORTED CUMULATIVELY OVER THE DURATION OF THE PROGRAM, WHICH MADE IT DIFFICULT TO EVALUATE PROGRESS TOWARD GOALS OR IDENTIFY TRENDS OVER TIME. FOR EXAMPLE, REPORTING 59 CLOSURES OVER THE DURATION OF THE PROGRAM DOES NOT PROVIDE AS MUCH INSIGHT INTO THE FREQUENCY OF THE ENCAMPMENT CLOSURES. DURING THE AUDIT PERIOD OF TIME, THE HRT DID NOT REPORT ON CERTAIN OUTCOMES THAT CONNECTED THEIR GOAL OF REDUCING UNSHELTERED HOMELESSNESS. FOR EXAMPLE, THEY DID NOT REPORT ON OUTREACH OUTCOMES LIKE THE NUMBER OF COORDINATED ENTRY ASSESSMENTS OR NUMBER OF OUTREACH ENCOUNTERS. THESE OUTCOMES CAN SHED LIGHT ON THE STARTING POINT OF THE PROCESS TO GET PEOPLE TO SERVICES AND SHELTER. ADDITIONALLY, WHILE THE HRT ON THE NUMBER OF SHELTERS, THEY DID REPORT ON THE NUMBER OF SHELTER ENROLLMENTS DURING THE AUDIT PERIOD. IN MAY OF 2025, THE HRT UPDATED THE REPORTING PROCESS AND DID INCLUDE NEW OUTCOMES. GOING FORWARD, IT WILL BE IMPORTANT FOR THE HRT TO CONSISTENTLY REPORT ON THESE OUTCOMES TO PROVIDE MORE INFORMATION ON THE PROCESS OF INITIAL OUTREACH TO ULTIMATELY BEING SHELTERED. OR THE INFORMATION THAT COULD BE USEFUL TO REPORT CONSISTENTLY TO

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COUNCIL GOING FORWARD INCLUDE DEMOGRAPHIC DATA, SUCH AS RACE, GENDER, HEALTH CONDITIONS OF ENCAMPMENT RESIDENTS AND THE REASONS WHY PEOPLE DECLINE SHELTER. WE ALSO FOUND THAT HRT'S REPORTS WERE A LITTLE DIFFICULT TO ACCESS ON THE CITY'S WEBSITE. THESE REPORTS WERE PUBLISHED IN TWO DIFFERENT PLACES ON THE WEBSITE WITHOUT A CENTRAL LANDING PAGE, WHICH MADE IT DIFFICULT TO ACCESS INFORMATION ABOUT THEIR WORK IN ENCAMPMENTS. AS A COMPARISON, OTHER JURISDICTIONS PROVIDE THE PUBLIC WITH MORE ACCESSIBLE INFORMATION ON THEIR EFFORTS TO ASSIST ENCAMPMENT RESIDENTS. FOR EXAMPLE, THE CITY AND COUNTY OF SAN FRANCISCO MAKES INFORMATION ABOUT COORDINATED ENTRY ACCESSIBLE TO THE PUBLIC THROUGH A PUBLIC FACING DASHBOARD. ANOTHER EXAMPLE IS THE CITY OF ISSAQUAH, WASHINGTON, WHICH REPORTS OUTCOMES ON A DASHBOARD ON THE NUMBER OF MONTHLY FACE TO FACE INTERACTIONS WITH CLIENTS. WITHOUT BEING ABLE TO EASILY ACCESS HRT DATA ON A WEBSITE OR DASHBOARD, COUNCIL OR MEMBERS OF THE PUBLIC MAY NOT UNDERSTAND THE EXTENT TO WHICH HRT HAS BEEN SUCCESSFUL IN REDUCING PROGRAM GOALS OF REDUCING UNSHELTERED HOMELESSNESS. IT BECOMES DIFFICULT FOR OVERSIGHT BODIES TO PROVIDE ADEQUATE OVERSIGHT OVER THEIR ACTIVITIES. THIS AUDIT INCLUDED SIX RECOMMENDATIONS TO IMPROVE COORDINATION AND ADDRESS DATA INCONSISTENCY WE RECOMMENDED THE HRT DOCUMENT PROCEDURES FOR COORDINATION WITH SERVICE PROVIDERS AND DATA COLLECTION AS WELL

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AS USE A SHARED MAPPING TOOL. TO MORE EFFECTIVELY MEASURE THE HRT'S IMPACT AND ENHANCED TRANSPARENCY, WE RECOMMEND THAT THEY EXPAND ON THEIR REPORTED OUTCOMES AND CONSIDER SHARING PUBLIC REPORTS IN A MORE ACCESSIBLE FORMAT. FINALLY, WE RECOMMEND THE HRT ASSESS STAFFING RESOURCES IN ORDER TO MAKE THESE IMPROVEMENTS. I DO WANT TO ACKNOWLEDGE THE BUDGET CHALLENGES THAT THE CITY IS FACING, BUT I, YOU KNOW, WANTED TO HIGHLIGHT IN THIS REPORT, AS THIS REPORT WAS BEING COMPLETED, I DID WANT TO HIGHLIGHT, YOU KNOW, IN ADDITION TO HRT AGREEING WITH OUR FINDINGS AND RECOMMENDATIONS AND PROPOSED IMPLEMENTATION PLAN FOR THESE AUDIT RECOMMENDATIONS, HRT DID STATE THAT THEY PLAN TO FORMALIZE A COORDINATION STRUCTURE FOR ENCAMPMENT RELATED MEETINGS, FORMALIZE INTERNAL WORK FLOWS FOR COLLECTING, REVIEWING AND VERIFYING DATA RELATED TO OUTREACH CONTACTS, SHELTER ENCAMPMENTS AND ACTIVITIES BUY REGULARLY USING A SHARED MAPPING TOOL AS PART OF THE HRT CASE CONFERENCE PROCESS AND PUBLISH THEIR PERFORMANCE DATA REPORTS ON THEIR WEB PAGE. AND I ALSO WANTED TO ACKNOWLEDGE THAT I SEE THERE WAS AN ADDITIONAL POSITION THAT WAS ALLOCATED TO THE HRT THAT COUNCIL HAD APPROVED THAT WILL HOPEFULLY PROVIDE SOME ADDITIONAL ASSISTANCE TO THIS TEAM. I JUST WANTED TO END WITH THANKING THE HOMELESS RESPONSE TEAM AND THE CITY MANAGER'S OFFICE FOR THEIR COOPERATION THROUGHOUT THIS AUDIT. WE ALSO WANT TO THANK THE CITY ATTORNEY'S

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OFFICE AND HHS C AND PUBLIC WORKS AND COMMUNITY MEMBERS FOR THEIR CONTRIBUTIONS TO THIS AUDIT AND FINALLY TO MY TEAM WERE SIGNIFICANT CONTRIBUTORS TO THIS WORK. AND I JUST WANTED TO ASK IF THE CITY MANAGER HAD ANY COMMENTS TO ADD AT THIS TIME?

>> STAFF: SURE, THANK YOU. FIRST OF ALL, I WOULD LIKE TO THANK YOU BOTH AUDITOR WONG AND YOUR TEAM FOR WORKING SO CLOSELY ON US WITH THIS AUDIT. I KNOW WE HAD A LOT OF BACK AND FORTH ON IT, SO WE WANT TO APPRECIATE THAT. ONE THING I DO WANT TO CORRECT IN OUR FORMAL RECOMMENDATION TO 3.1, WE WOULD RECOMMEND PROVIDE QUARTERLY REPORTS AND WHAT WE NEED TO DO INSTEAD IS PROVIDE BIANNUAL REPORTS. THERE WON'T BE MEANINGFUL CHANGES IN A QUARTER THAT WILL BE HELPFUL TO LOOK AT. INSTEAD OF PROVIDING QUARTERLY REPORTS IN AUGUST 1ST, 2025 WE WILL START BIANNUAL REPORTS OCTOBER THIRTY-FIRST 2025. THAT'S IT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU ALL SO MUCH. I FEEL LIKE I SHOULD ALSO -- [APPLAUSE] YEAH, I WANT TO ACKNOWLEDGE THAT, LIKE, AUDITS THEMSELVES I THINK CAN SOMETIMES FEEL AWKWARD FOR FOLKS BECAUSE YOU ARE TAKING A LOOK AT THE WORK THAT'S GOING ON AND GIVING SOME FEEDBACK ON THINGS THAT WE CAN DO BETTER. I JUST WANT TO SAY I MEAN POSITION, REALLY FEEL THAT'S JUST ABOUT MAKING US BETTER AND WE ALL SHOULD BE SUPPORTIVE OF THAT. I REALLY WANT TO THANK ALL THE TEAMS, YOUR TEAM FOR DOING THE AUDIT, BUT ALSO EVERYONE WHO WAS INVOLVED IN PROVIDING

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INFORMATION BECAUSE I KNOW THIS IS ABOUT MAKING US BETTER AND DOING A BETTER JOB OF SERVING OUR COMMUNITY, SO THANK YOU ALL VERY MUCH. I REALLY APPRECIATE ALSO THE CITY MANAGER AND HIS RESPONSE AND PERIOD OF TIME, AND YOUR TEAM, TOO FOR PROVIDING THE FEEDBACK ON THE CHANGES YOU ARE GOING TO MAKE AS WELL. SO THERE ARE -- WHAT I WANT TO DO, ACTUALLY, ARE THERE ANY BURNING QUESTIONS FOR OUR AUDITORS? OTHERWISE, WHAT I WANT TO DO IS TO DO PUBLIC COMMENT SO WE CAN HEAR FROM FOLKS AND THEN DO COUNCIL COMMENTS AND QUESTIONS TOGETHER.

>> YEAH, I HAVE QUESTIONS, BUT I WOULD NOT CHARACTERIZE THEM AS BURNING.

>> I HAVE A BURNING QUESTION.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY. BURNING QUESTION OVER HERE.

>> I SHOULD HAVE BROUGHT MY PEN. I DID WANT TO SAY I AM GLAD TO HEAR THAT HRT HAS ACCESS TO THE COUNTY'S COORDINATED ENTRY SYSTEM. I AM WONDERING WHETHER THAT NEW ACCESS WILL IMPROVE THE TEAM'S CAPACITY TO REPORT ON THE OUTCOMES IDENTIFIED IN THE AUDIT OR ADMIN?

>> I THINK THAT'S FOR --

>> YEAH, PETER CAN ANSWER THAT QUESTION WITH MORE DETAIL, BUT THE SHORT ANSWER IS YES, IT WILL. AND TO WHAT EXTENT DEPENDS A LITTLE BIT ON HOW MUCH DATA WE HAVE ACCESS TO AND HOW THAT ALL UNFOLDS, BUT YEAH, WE ARE LOOKING FORWARD TO DOING THAT.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY. ANOTHER BURNING QUESTION FROM COUNCILMEMBER TREGUB AND THEN COUNCILMEMBER O'KEEFE.

>> I. TREGUB: THIS IS JUST A CLARIFICATION TO SOMETHING YOU SAID, PAUL, WHEN YOU SAID BIANNUAL.

>> STAFF: TWICE A YEAR. YEAH, EVERY OTHER YEAR, JUST KIDDING. TWICE A YEAR, EVERY SIX MONTHS INSTEAD OF QUARTERLY.

>> I. TREGUB: THANK YOU SO MUCH.

>> MAYOR ISHII: GO AHEAD.

>> S. O'KEEFE: YEAH, JUST A FACTUAL QUESTION I THINK WOULD BE HELPFUL TO GET OUT BEFORE THE PUBLIC COMMENT, THIS IS FOR THE CITY MANAGER'S TEAM, THE MAY 20TH ITEM THAT THE PRESENTATION WAS LARGELY RESPONSIVE TO ALSO INCLUDED AS THE CENTRAL ITEM A REQUEST THAT THE CITY MANAGER PRODUCE A LIST OF POSSIBLE LOCATIONS FOR AN ALTERNATE SHELTER SITE. I WAS JUST WONDERING IF YOU COULD GIVE A BRIEF UPDATE ON THE STATUS OF THAT?

>> STAFF: YES, WE DO HAVE A DRAFT LIST PUT TOGETHER. EVEN TODAY WE WERE GOING BACK AND FORTH ON VARIOUS ASPECTS OF THEM BECAUSE WE WANT TO PROVIDE A LIST THAT HAS BOTH PRIVATE SPACES THAT COULD BE LEASED AS WELL AS PUBLIC SPACES AND THEN PROVIDE A LITTLE BIT CONTEXT ON THE PUBLIC SPACES, LIKE, WHAT THEY ARE BEING USED FOR NOW. AND SO WE ARE CLOSE AND ANTICIPATE BRINGING THAT BACK TO YOU IN OCTOBER.

>> S. O'KEEFE: THANK YOU SO MUCH. APPRECIATE THAT.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: YEAH, THANK YOU FOR ASKING THAT. THAT'S IMPORTANT. ANOTHER BURNING QUESTION.

>> IT'S NOT BURNING, JUST MORE OF A SMOLDERING QUESTION. THANK YOU MADAM AUDITOR AND THE CITY TEAM FOR YOUR WORK HERE. I JUST WANT TO GIVE THE TEAM TIME TO CALCULATE TO THE BEST YOU CAN, I AM LOOKING FOR THE -- THE DOLLAR VALUE OR MAYBE PERCENTAGE VALUE, SOME VALUE WE CAN THINK ABOUT OF THE FEDERAL TAX CREDITS THAT WE DEPLOY TO EFFECT THESE GOALS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY. AND WITH THAT, I WANT TO OPEN IT UP FOR PUBLIC COMMENTS ON EITHER PRESENTATION. SINCE I IMAGINE THERE WILL BE A FAIR AMOUNT OF COMMENTS, FEEL FREE TO STEP DOWN. YOU ARE WELCOME TO IF YOU WANT TO. GO AHEAD. COME ON UP. YEAH, I AM NOT SURE, I KNOW THERE ARE A LOT OF FOLKS HERE, I AM NOT SURE IF YOU ARE HERE LISTEN IN OR TO SPEAK. THAT DETERMINES HOW MUCH TIME FOLKS FETE. RAISE YOUR HAND IF YOU ARE GOING TO GIVE PUBLIC COMMENT. IN THAT CASE, WE CAN DO TWO MINUTES, I THINK, YEAH. GO AHEAD.

>> IT SAYS ONE. IS IT ONE OR TWO?

>> MAYOR ISHII: I THINK WE CAN GIVE TWO BECAUSE THERE ARE ONLY A HANDFUL OF FOCUSING.

>> THAT YOU CAN. JOHN SO OF DOWNTOWN BERKELEY ASSOCIATION. THANK YOU BOTH FOR YOUR PRESENTATION. I WANT TO THANK THE CITY STAFF AND COUNCIL AND MAYOR FOR THE WORK IN CIVIC CENTER PARK. IT'S

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MADE A FUNDAMENTAL DIFFERENCE AND I THINK WE ARE ALL PROUD THE PATH WE ARE ON THERE, SO THANK YOU. A COUPLE OF THE COMMENTS, I THINK IT REALLY WOULD BE HELPFUL TO HAVE A DASHBOARD SIMILAR TO THESE OTHER CITIES TO SHOW THE NUMBER OF BEDS AND METRICS ETC. DISCUSSION AROUND SHELTER BEDS, WE TALK ABOUT CONGREGATE AND NON-CONGREGATE, THERE ARE OTHER ALTERNATIVES. WE DESCRIBE AS HYBRID SHELTER BEDS OR PRIVATE CONGREGATE SHELTERS. I THINK THE HORIZONTAL TRANSITIONAL VILLAGE, WHICH PROVIDED PRIVACY, WAS EXTREMELY SUCCESSFUL. IT LENDED A LOT OF PRIVACY AND DOROTHY DAY HOUSE DID A GREAT JOB. I THINK WHERE THE ALTERNATIVE HOUSING OPTIONS THAT'S CLEARLY SOMETHING WE SHOULD LOOK AT, SIGNIFICANTLY, SIGNIFICANTLY LOWER COSTS. ALSO, WE CANNOT AFFORD EITHER A COST OR OTHER OUR HOSPITAL AT INDUSTRY CONTINUE TO MAKE MORE MOTELS OUT OF SERVICE. WE NEED AN INVENTORY OF MODERATELY PRICED MOTELS FOR PEOPLE TO VISIT. A NEW HOTEL IS NICE, BUT WE HAVE TO PROVIDE A MOTEL CAPABILITY. HOMELESS COUNT, I TALKED TO OUR PRIOR MAYOR AND PRIOR COUNCILMEMBER ON MEASURE P, PLEASE PUT MORE MONEY IN THERE FOR HOMELESS COUNTS. AS YOU DO WE DO A HOMELESS COUNT TWICE A MONTH. IT TAKES US ABOUT TWO HOURS TO COVER THE ENTIRE DOWNTOWN. CITYWIDE IS PROBABLY 20 TO 25 PERSONAL HOURS. TO BE DOING HOMELESS COUNTS ONLY ONCE EVERY TWO YEARS, IT DOESN'T MAKES SENSE. A LOT OF CITIES AND COUNTIES DO IT MORE THAN ONCE THAN EVERY TWO YEARS.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. YOU ARE OUT OF TIME. THANK YOU SO MUCH.

>> HI. FIRST, I WOULD LIKE TO THANK JENNY WONG PUTTING TOGETHER FOR THIS REPORT. I HAVE THE UTMOST RESPECT FOR YOUR WORK AND THIS SUBJECT HITS CLOSE TO HOME TO ME, NO PUN INTENDED. AFTER LIVING ON THE STREETS OF BERKELEY FOR MORE THAN THREE DECADES, YOU WOULD THINK I WOULD HAVE BEEN OFFERED SHELTER MORE THAN FOUR TIMES. I HAVE ACCEPTED ALL FOUR, YET THROUGH NO FAULT OF MY OWN, I SPENT THE LAST 28 YEARS MOSTLY HOMELESS. AFTER I LEFT THE GRAYSON LOT I MOVED WITH MY NEIGHBORS TO DWIGHT WAY WHERE WE HAVE BEEN FOR TWO YEARS. UNTIL A MONTH AGO, NONE OF THE US RECEIVED ANYTHING RESEMBLING SHELTER SINCE THE LOT CLOSED. THIS AUDIT EXPLAINS WHY. THERE ARE MORE THAN TWICE AS MANY UNHOUSED PEOPLE HERE AS THERE ARE BEDS AND HRT ONLY CONTROLS A HANDFUL OF THOSE, YET PEOPLE LIKE ME GET LABELED SERVICE RESISTANT DESPITE NEVER REFUSING SHELTER. THE TRUTH IS THE SYSTEM IS RESISTANT TO LETTING US IN. SAFE ENCAMPMENTS AND SAFE RV PARKING LOTS SHOULD BE A PRIORITY. IT WOULD COST THE LEAST EFFORT FOR THE HRT. THANK YOU [APPLAUSE]

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU SO MUCH. APPRECIATE YOUR COMMENTS.

>> AFTERNOON, EVERYONE. DOUG JONES POLITICAL ORGANIZING FOR UNITED HEALTH CARE WORKERS AND REPRESENT OVER 10,000 HEALTH CARE WORKERS THROUGHOUT THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA INCLUDING MANY

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THOUSANDS HERE IN THE COUNTY AND OVER A THOUSAND AT THE SUMMIT FACILITIES. ONE OF THE THINGS THAT WAS STRIKING TO ME IN THE REPORT WAS THAT WHILE 2/3RD OF THE PEOPLE THAT WERE ENGAGED IN THE COMPASSIONATE INTERVENTIONS BY HRT RESPONDED WELL, THAT MEANS 1/3RD OF THEM DID NOT. AND OBVIOUSLY, IN MANY CASES THAT IS CAUSED BY BEHAVIORAL HEALTH HEALTH CHALLENGES. THE WORKERS THAT WE REPRESENT AT THE SUMMIT AND THE REST OF THE CENTER SYSTEM THROUGHOUT NORTHERN CALIFORNIA ARE DISTRESSED BY SUTTER HEALTH'S SLOW STEADY DETERIORATION OF ITS COMMITMENT TO BEHAVIORAL HEALTH ISSUES. THAT'S BEEN VISITED ALONG ALAMEDA COUNTY IS THE FACILITY I USED TO HAVE WORK AT FOR 25 YEARS USED TO HAVE A 25-BED INPATIENT PSYCH UNIT THERE. THOSE ARE SETTINGS THAT ARE UNIQUE. THIS IS SOMETHING THAT'S DIFFERENT FROM THE BEHAVIORAL HEALTH CARE THAT'S BEING DONE AT LIFELONG AND OR THE TYPES OF FACILITIES. THAT WAS A REAL LOSS WHEN SUTTER HEALTH DECIDED TO CLOSE THAT 25-BED PSYCH UNIT. DWIGHT WAY THEY ARE REPORTING THE FUTURE OF SERVICES THERE IS VERY UNCERTAIN. WE KNOW THE SUBSTANTIAL PORTION OF ACUTE CARE SERVICES AT THE ASHBY CAMPUS ARE GOING TO BE GOING AWAY IN 2030 AND REPLACED IN EMERYVILLE, BUT THINGS ARE VERY UNCERTAIN ALSO AT DWIGHT WAY. SO IT'S GOING TO BE REALLY IMPORTANT TO FOLLOW THAT AND WE ARE GOING TO CONTINUE TO ENGAGE WITH THE CITY COUNCIL AND ANYONE WHO WILL LISTEN ABOUT THE IMPORTANCE OF MAINTAINING THESE SORTS OF

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SAFETY NET SERVICES. THANKS A LOT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. THANK YOU VERY MUCH.

>> HI. I AM ON THE BERKELEY BEHAVIORAL HEALTH COMMISSION AS IT IS NOW CALLED, AND A COUPLE OF THINGS HAVE OCCURRED TO ME. I WAS WONDERING SOMEBODY SAID THAT THEY HAD HEARD THAT A LOT OF THIS, YOU KNOW, I WAS WONDERING ABOUT THE -- THE PRESENCE OF SOCIAL WORKERS AND PEOPLE ON THE OUTREACH TEAM, MOST IN THE PAST OUTREACH TEAMS HAVE HAD THAT. THE OUTREACH TEAM USED TO BE PART OF THE MENTAL HEALTH DEPARTMENT, AND THEN WHEN STAFFING BECAME SO DIFFICULT, I THINK, FOR THAT DEPARTMENT, THE CITY TOOK THAT OVER AND IT BECAME THE CRT. AND IT FEELS LIKE THERE HAS BEEN A LACK OF CONTACT AND CONNECTION WITH THE MENTAL HEALTH FACILITIES. I KNOW THAT BONITA HOUSE WAS DOING, WORKING ON THE SCU, SPECIALIZED CARE UNIT. THAT WAS AN IMPORTANT PROJECT THAT RAN OUT AFTER THE PILOT, AND SO NOW ALL OF THAT EQUIPMENT, CARS AND VEHICLES HAVE GONE TO ALAMEDA COUNTY. SO, YOU KNOW, I AM THINKING THAT BERKELEY HAS SORT OF GIVEN AWAY STUFF TO ALAMEDA COUNTY. WE HAVE NO AMBER HOUSE LIKE ALAMEDA COUNTY HAS. I WOULD LIKE TO SEE MORE CONNECTION. ANOTHER QUESTION IS THE STORY IS THAT THERE IS SUPPORTIVE HOUSING PLANNED FOR THE PEOPLE'S PARK AREA, AND APPARENTLY THAT CONTRACT HAS DISAPPEARED. FRANKLY, I WONDER WHO ARE THE SUPPORTIVE SERVICES PROVIDERS? THAT'S A BIG QUESTION IN MY MIND. THEY DON'T GET MUCH HELP FROM THE CITY.

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THEY SAY OH, WE WILL LOOK TO BOSS, LOOK TO LIFELONG, BUT THAT'S NOT REALLY THE REAL SUPPORTIVE SERVICES THAT MANY OF THESE MENTALLY ILL PEOPLE WHO END UP IN THIS HOUSING NEED. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. THANKS SO MUCH. I WILL ASK SOME OF THOSE QUESTIONS, SO APPRECIATE IT.

>> STEVEN, FRIENDS OF OHLONE PARK. DURING THE ENCAMPMENT IN OHLONE PARK, IT WOULD HAVE BEEN VERY HELPFUL TO HAD A FACILITY LIKE THE GRAYSON STREET TEMPORARY SHELTER, WHICH BY ALL ACCOUNTS WAS A GREAT SUCCESS. AND I KNOW THE CITY IS ENGAGED IN FINDING OTHER SITES THANKS TO A COUNCIL RESOLUTION AND WORK BY THE CITY MANAGER'S OFFICE. BUT WHY CONFINE THIS TO BERKELEY? THERE ARE MANY PLACES IN THE COUNTY THAT MIGHT BE MUCH MORE READILY AND AFFORDABLY AVAILABLE AND I AM WONDERING IF THE CITY IS ENGAGING WITH THE COUNTY TO IDENTIFY SITES LIKE THAT? ALSO IN VIEW OF THE CITY'S DEFICIT AND THE LACK OF FUNDING FROM FEDERAL AND STATE SOURCES THAT THE HOMELESS RESPONSE BY THE CITY HAS RELIED ON, WHERE IS THE STATUS OF THE CITY'S NEGOTIATION TO GET A FAIR SHARE OF THE MEASURE W FUNDING? THAT'S GOING TO BE VERY IMPORTANT. I WANT TO KNOW HOW MUCH THE CITY CAN GET, AND WHAT -- HOW IT WOULD BE ALLOCATED. AND ALSO, I WOULD ASK THAT RECENTLY FRIENDS OF OHLONE PARK HAD A MEETING WITH COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI AND TREGUB AND WE WERE URGED TO WRITE THE COUNTY BOARD OF SUPERVISORS TO RAISE THE ISSUE ABOUT A GOOD SHARE OF FUNDING

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FOR THE CITY OF BERKELEY. AND I THINK ON THIS OCCASION, I WOULD LIKE THE COUNCIL TO SPEAK TO THIS AUDIENCE ABOUT HOW TO ADDRESS THE COUNTY ON THAT ISSUE.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> THANK YOU, AGAIN, EVERYONE UP HERE AND IN THE AUDIENCE, AND THE REPORTERS. I REALLY WANT TO SECOND THE COMMENT ON MORE POINT IN TIME COUNTS. FOR THOSE OF US WHO HAVE EITHER BEEN ON THE STREET OR TENDING PEOPLE ON THE STREET, IT REALLY VACILLATES AND FLUCTUATES AND PEOPLE NEED TO PAY ATTENTION TO THAT. IN ADDITION TO WHICH I REALLY WOULD LIKE TO EXPLORE MORE NON-POLICE INTERVENTIONS. I AM CONSTANTLY BECAUSE I AM OUT AND ABOUT ROAMING EVERYWHERE THAT I KNOW PEOPLE ARE, YOU KNOW, I GET -- I RUN INTO PLENTY OF PEOPLE THAT COULD USE SOME ASSISTANCE. AND THAT'S THE OTHER POINT; YOU PUT PEOPLE IN SHELTERS. THEY STILL NEED CARE. I HAVE A NUMBER OF PEOPLE IN THE RESIDENCE WHERE I LIVE THAT ARE NOT GETTING THE CARE AND THEY CAN'T FUNCTION, SO THEY NEED MORE SUPPORTIVE CARE. WHEN IT COMES TO CONGREGATE SHELTERS THAT SOME OF US DON'T WANT, I REALLY WANT YOU TO KNOW I WANT TO BE FANCY AND HAVE MY OWN PRIVATE BOUDOIR. IT'S THAT SOME OF US LIKE WOMEN AND ELDERS AND DISABLED PEOPLE, ESPECIALLY, HAVE BEEN VIOLENTLY AND EMOTIONALLY ABUSED. AND I PHYSICALLY WOULD NOT SURVIVE IN A SETTING LIKE THAT BECAUSE JUST ONE TURN WITH SOMEBODY'S BACKPACK AND I AM ON THE GROUND. SO I HAVE AS

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AMBER MENTIONED, I HAVE NOT REFUSED, BUT I AM NOT GOING TO GO ANYWHERE SO I CAN SLEEP THAT WILL KILL ME. THAT'S VERY IMPRACTICAL. I WANT TO EMPHASIZE THAT WE HAVE A LOT MORE RESOURCES IN THE COMMUNITY THAN CHASING AFTER MONEY THAT MIGHT COME SOME DAY. WE HAVE A LOT MORE CAPACITY TO CREATE OUR OWN SPACE IF WE CAN FIND IT AND JOIN TOGETHER WITH THE RESOURCES THAT WE HAVE BECAUSE WE CARE AND WE SHARE. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANKS, MARIA.

>> I REALLY TRIED.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YOU GOT IT. YOU ARE GOOD. THANK YOU.

>> ONE REALLY BIG GAPING HOLE IN ALL OF THESE SUGGESTIONS, REPORTS, PROGRAMS, ETC., IS A LACK OF INVOLVEMENT WITH THE UNHOUSED THEMSELVES. I DON'T SEE HOW MUCH IT REALLY GETS DONE WITHOUT INVOLVING IN SOME KIND OF DECISION MAKING CAPACITY WITH THE UNHOUSED THEMSELVES.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> I COULDN'T AGREE MORE. AND I FIGURE YOU ALL NEED A BREAK TO ONE. I CAN'T TELL WHAT YOU ALL ARE THINKING, BUT I BROUGHT THIS BANDANNA THAT SAYS -- ONLY THE PEOPLE CAN SAVE THE PEOPLE. AND LIKE THIS GENTLEMAN WAS JUST SAYING, I AM WONDERING WHERE THE VOICES OF THE UNHOUSED PEOPLE IN THIS REPORT? I DON'T SEE THAT. AND I AM ACTUALLY FEELING QUITE PESSIMISTIC ABOUT THIS AUDIT GIVEN THE RESPONSE THAT THIS BODY, THIS CITY COUNCIL HAS HAD NOT

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JUST TO THE PEOPLE IN BERKELEY, BUT TO THE PEOPLE AROUND THE WORLD AND IN GAZA. THIS AUDIT DOES LITTLE TO CAPTURE THE VOICES OF OUR UNHOUSED NEIGHBORS. IF THE COUNCIL TRULY WANTS TO MAKE CHANGE, IT WILL LISTEN TO THE VOICES OF THE PEOPLE MOST IMPACTED. PEOPLE WHOSE LIVES HANG IN THE BALANCE EVERY TIME A SWEEP, AN EVICTION NOTICE ARE GIVEN. EVERY TIME THE POLICE DRIVE DOWN THE STREET, RIDE THEIR BICYCLES AND ESPECIALLY, WHEN THE HOMELESS RESPONSE TEAM ARRIVES IN AN ENCAMPMENT OR TENT, THE VERY PEOPLE MEANT TO QUOTE ASSIST HAVE BECOME AN ARM OF THE POLICE. THE TEAM CREATES TRAUMA AND PERPETUATES TRAUMA. IF THE COUNCIL TRULY WANTS TO MAKE CHANGE, THEY WILL LISTEN TO THE PEOPLE MOST IMPACTED WITH DIGNITY. LISTEN TO THEIR BOUNDARIES. FOLLOW UP WITH THEIR REQUESTS. PROVIDE BATHROOMS AND REPEATED REQUESTS FOR TRASH PICKUPS. I KNOW COUNTLESS PEOPLE HAVE MADE PHONE CALLS AND YOU GO DOWN TO 8TH AND HARRISON; THERE IS NO DUMPSTER THERE. PEOPLE IN THE COMMUNITY, CONTRACTORS GO DUMP THEIR TRASH THERE. MY TIME IS LIMITED, BUT I KNOW WHAT I AM NOT SEEING IS NOT IN THIS REPORT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. I APPRECIATE YOUR COMMENTS. [INDISCERNIBLE].

>> MAYOR ISHII: FOLKS, SO MARK, THIS IS MORE PEOPLE THAN I WAS EXPECTING AND ARE THERE FOLKS ONLINE?

>> CITY CLERK: YES.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: HOW MANY FOLKS ONLINE. I THINK WE MIGHT NEED TO MOVE TO ONE MINUTE. I AM SORRY, GEORGE. THAT'S WHY I ASKED FOLKS TO STAND UP BECAUSE I WANTED TO HAVE A SENSE OF HOW MANY PEOPLE WERE COMING.

>> CITY CLERK: SIX HANDS RAISED.

>> MAYOR ISHII: SORRY.

>> GEORGE LITTMAN AND SPEAKING ONLY FOR MYSELF, YES LISTEN TO THE VOICES OF PEOPLE MOST IMPACTED. LET'S FIND A WAY TO MAKE THAT HAPPEN. WE ARE STANDING HERE. IT'S SUMMER. IT'S WANING, BUT IT'S SUMMER. IT'S REALLY NICE, BUT WINTER IS COMING, SO I WANT TO RAISE WHAT I UNDERSTAND IS GOING ON, WHICH COULD CREATE A VAST EMERGENCY VERY SOON, CLOSURE OF THE WINTER SHELTER DUE TO RETROFITTING, UNDERSTANDABLE, AT OLD CITY HALL. AS I UNDERSTAND IT, I HOPE THIS IS WRONG, THE REPLACEMENT FOR THIS YEAR IS NOT IN BERKELEY. IT'S SOME OTHER CITY. THAT'S A RECIPE FOR DISASTER. TO EXPECT PEOPLE TO GET THERE ON THEIR OWN IS UNREALISTIC. AND I THINK IF WE ARE AUDITING THINGS, WE SHOULD COUNT THE NUMBER OF DEATHS THAT ARE GOING TO COME BECAUSE EVERY YEAR WE DON'T HAVE SUFFICIENT SHELTER, PEOPLE DIE. PLEASE KEEP THAT IN MIND AND FIND A BETTER PLAN WITHIN THE NEXT TWO MONTHS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [APPLAUSE]

>> FIRST, THE CITY HAS DONE AN EXCEPTIONAL JOB OF APPLYING FOR GRANTS AND LOOKING FOR MONEY, SOMETHING THAT'S BADLY NEEDED. THE

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MOTEL CONVERSIONS HAVE BEEN EXTREMELY SUCCESSFUL. WE ARE IN A FINANCIAL CRISIS AND HOPEFULLY THE CONTINUE OF HORIZON WAS SUCCESSFUL IN PART BECAUSE IT DID RESPECT PRIVACY IN THE WAY IT WAS CONSTRUCTED AND IT RESPECTED THE CLIENT'S RIGHTS. DIFFERENT COMMUNITY MEMBERS HAVE BEEN CONTACTING ME REGULARLY WITH VARIOUS REFERRALS, WITH CLIENT REFERRALS. THEY HAVE BEEN CONTACTING ME AS A PERSON WITH ABSOLUTELY NO AUTHORITY. I AM ALSO FREQUENTLY CONTACTED WITH INQUIRIES AS TO HOW THE HOMELESS SYSTEM WORKS IN OUR CITY. I HAVE FOUND THE OPTIONS ENCAMPMENT MOBILE WELLNESS TEAM TO BE THE MOST RESPONSIVE OF ALL. THEY ARE FUNDED THROUGH THE MHSA FOR FOUR YEARS. THEY RESPOND TO THE CLIENT CASES THAT I AM RECEIVING FREQUENTLY.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANKS, CAROL. [APPLAUSE]

>> SO I ACTUALLY HAD A QUESTION OVER A COMMENT. THE HRT REPORTED ON THE NUMBER OF ENCAMPMENTS CLOSED, BUT WHERE ARE THE NUMBERS OF WHAT THAT COST? SO HOW MUCH DOES IT COST TO CLOSE EACH ENCAMPMENT FOR THE COPS AND THE EQUIPMENT? HOW MUCH DID THE CITY SPEND ON SMOKE BOMBS, ON UNHOUSED COMMUNITY MEMBERS ON 8TH AND HARRISON? WHERE IS THAT AUDIT? WHERE ARE THE RECEIPTS OF WHAT THEY ARE SPENDING? WE SEE A LOT OF CHARTS AND THINGS, BUT I WOULD LIKE TO SEE SOME RECEIPTS WHERE THEY ARE SPENDING ALL OF THIS MONEY. HOW MUCH IS THAT COSTING?

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANKS FOR YOUR QUESTION. LET'S MOVE TO THE

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FOLKS ONLINE.

>> CITY CLERK: ALRIGHT FIRST SPEAKER ONLINE IS JESSICA PRADO. YOU HAVE ONE MINUTE.

>> HELLO. HI I AM REPRESENTATIVE OF THE BERKELEY HOMELESS UNION. I WANT TO SAY THAT I FOUND THE AUDIT VERY QUESTIONABLE AND NOT TRANSPARENT. THE CITY AUDITOR RESPONDED ON INFORMATION THAT DOES NOT REFLECT ON THE AUDITOR BUT OUTREACH WORKERS. ONE LIFELONG OUTREACH WORKER SENDS A LETTER TO THE CITY. THE STAFF MEMBER WISHES THERE WERE MORE CLARIFICATION OF QUESTIONS TO THE CITY ON HEALTH RELATED MATTERS FOR EXAMPLE IF ANYONE IS DYING, HOW MANY PREGNANT PEOPLE IN THE ENCAMPMENT AND HOW MANY PEOPLE IN OPIOID DISORDER USE TREATMENT. THE SOMETIMES HRT ACTIVITIES DIRECTLY IMPACT PEOPLE'S ABILITIES TO GET HOW'S THE. THERE IS CONFUSION AMONG PROVIDERS ABOUT HOW THE CITY IS DECIDING TO PLACE IN CITY RUN HOUSING SHELTERS. LIFELONG SAYS THEY ARE NOT CONSULTED WHO MAY NEED SHELTER THE MOST. OFTEN OUR UNION MEMBERS REPORT TO US THAT HRT WORKERS PULL STRINGS TO GET THEM INTO SHELTER. IT SEEMS THAT ALLOCATION OF SHELTER.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I AM SORRY, YOUR TIME SUP. THANKS FOR YOUR COMMENT.

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS KELLY.

>> OKAY. IN GOING THROUGH THE REPORT, I SEE LOTS OF STATISTICS, BUT I DIDN'T SEE WHAT THE AVERAGE INCOME IS FOR THE HOMELESS

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PERSON OR THE LONG-TERM SUCCESS RATE OF HOW LONG HOUSED PEOPLE STAY HOUSED. THE REASON I ASK A REPORT TO COUNCIL WITH REGARDS TO SUBSIDIZED HOUSING WITH A GRADUAL WITHDRAWAL WHAT I BELIEVE WAS THREE YEARS, THE AVERAGE INCOME WAS OVER $900 PER MONTH. I AM NOT MAKING A JUDGMENT WHETHER SOMEONE MUST WORKING TO RECEIVE HELP. I AM WONDERING HOW MUCH OF OUR HOMELESS ARE WORKING POOR WHO WILL NEVER BE ABLE TO AFFORD HOUSING AND DAILY LIVING EXPENSES LIKE FOOD. THOSE ARE REALLY MY QUESTIONS, AND I THINK I COVERED IT IN LESS -- I HAVE 11 SECONDS LEFT. SO PLEASE INCOME WOULD BE VERY HELPFUL. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU, KELLY.

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS ERIKA SHORE.

>> THANK YOU. I AM PART OF THE FRIENDS OF OHLONE PARK. AND I WANTED TO THANK THE CITY VERY MUCH FOR THE EFFORTS THAT I KNOW WERE VERY DIFFICULT OF THE CLEARING OF THE ENCAMPMENT IN OHLONE PARK. I UNDERSTAND THAT THE BASELINE QUESTION OF WHERE WE ARE TO GO IS STILL UNANSWERED AND I REALLY DO URGE THAT THERE BE A SOLUTION IN TERMS OF A SANCTIONED CAMPGROUND. AS STEVE MOST MENTIONED EARLIER, MY QUESTION IS WHAT WOULD THE COUNCIL LIKE CITY RESIDENTS TO DO TO ASSIST IN THE ADVOCACY FOR MORE ACCESS TO THE COORDINATED ENTRY SYSTEM? WE HAVE BEEN TOLD THAT THIS IS A HUGE BOTTLENECK. IN ADDITION TO THE FACT THAT IT SOUNDS LIKE YOU NEED $9 MILLION JUST TO KEEP RUNNING WHAT IS CURRENTLY OPEN,

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LET ALONE EXPANSION. SO CAN CITIZENS DO THAT WOULD BE HELPFUL AND SUPPORTIVE OF THESE EFFORTS? THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS RAINES OR BETSY. RAINES OR BETSY, YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO UN-MUTE.

>> HERE WE GO. SORRY. I AM ON A PHONE OUTSIDE. THANK YOU ALL, BETSY MORRIS. PART OF SEVERAL WORKING GROUPS, AND CO-CONVENER OF THE GRAY PANTHERS IN EAST BAY. THANK YOU FOR THESE REPORTS. THANK YOU FOR MAKING IT AVAILABLE FOR US ALL TO HEAR. FIRST I WANT TO FOLLOW UP ON THESE POINTS, I WILL FOLLOW UP, BUT ONE, WE STILL DON'T HAVE A GOOD MODEL FOR UNDERSTANDING HOW MANY HOMELESS PEOPLE WILL BE COMING ONLINE, YOU KNOW. AND THE BEST DATA THAT I KNOW OF THAT I HAVE HEARD OF IS TO UNDERSTAND THE ROOT CAUSES OF HOMELESSNESS A SHORT CENTURY MINUTE VIDEO FROM KING COUNTY IN WASHINGTON. I RECOMMEND PEOPLE GOOGLE THAT. TWO, WE CAN'T REALLY PLAN WITHOUT KNOWING WHAT THE PIPELINE LOOKS LIKE. SECOND, I REALLY WOULD LIKE TO SUGGEST.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I AM SORRY, YOUR TIME IS UP.

>> I WILL FOLLOW UP IN WRITING.

>> MAYOR ISHII: PLEASE FOLLOW UP.

>> CITY CLERK: NEXT IS BETH.

>> YES, HELLO BETH BERKELEY CHAMBER OF COMMERCE. FOUR PRIORITIES FOR BERKELEY'S HOMELESSNESS RESPONSE. FIRST ALAMEDA COUNTY

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SHOULD DEVELOP A LARGE-SCALE REGIONAL SYSTEM LIKE RENO'S CAMPUS. SECOND, AS NEARLY $1 BILLION IN MEASURE W FUNDS ACCUMULATE, BERKELEY DESERVES IT'S FAIR SHARE TO ADDRESS LOCAL NEEDS. THIRD, WE NEED FIRM CONSISTENT REINFORCEMENT OF OUR SIDEWALK ORDINANCES. OUR SIDEWALKS MUST REMAIN SAFE AND ACCESSIBLE FOR EVERYONE. AND FOURTH, WITH MORE FREQUENT CITYWIDE HOMELESS COUNTS QUARTERLY OR MONTHLY, WE COULD LIKELY RESPOND TO PROBLEMS BEFORE THEY BECOME MORE OVERWHELMING FOR CITY STAFF. THANK YOU SO MUCH TO HRT FOR THE WORK THAT YOU DO. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANKS, BETH.

>> CITY CLERK: THERE ARE TWO MORE SPEAKERS. NEXT IS BARBARA.

>> HI, I AM A LONG-TERM BERKELEY RESIDENT AND NOW A PROUD HOMEOWNER. I AM LIVING CLOSE TO THE VIRGINIA HOMELESS ENCAMPMENT. I WOULD LIKE TO HAVE A RESPONSE TO THE FACT THAT I MISSED THE FIRST PART OF YOUR MEETING, I AM SORRY, BUT MAYBE THE MAYOR CAN ANSWER THIS OR THE CITY MANAGER, GIVEN OUR DEFICIT, WHAT ARE THE CHANCES THERE WILL BE A PARTIAL TAX INCREASE FOR OUR TAXES IN THE NEXT YEAR OR TWO? I HAVE A PLAN AHEAD. I AM ON FIXED INCOME HERE AND I NEED TO KNOW AS A SENIOR CITIZEN AM I GOING TO HAVE TO PAY ANOTHER $500 A YEAR FOR THESE SERVICES. PLEASE ADVISE ME. IT FEELS LIKE AN OVERWHELMING TASK AND AS A HOMEOWNER I FEEL REALLY AFRAID THAT I MIGHT BE IN THE SAME BOAT IF MY TAXES GO UP MUCH MORE. THANK YOU.

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>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: LAST SPEAKER IS JEFF.

>> GOOD AFTERNOON, COUNCIL, I WOULD LIKE TO COMMENT THAT I COMMEND THE AUDITOR ON A REALLY GOOD FAITH EFFORT TO TRY TO UNPACK A REALLY CHALLENGING SITUATION, BUT AS MULTIPLE COMMENTERS HAVE ALREADY NOTED, THERE REALLY NEEDS TO BE A DATA COLLECTION STRATEGY FOR A NUMBER OF THESE ISSUES, INCLUDING UNHOUSED AND HOW OUR DOLLARS ARE, WHERE THEY ARE GOING. WE CAN'T COMPARE DATA OVER TIME. WITH THE CHANGE OF THE CITY'S WEBSITE, WE HAVE LOST A LOT OF DATA. SO I THINK A REALLY HONEST CONVERSATION ABOUT WHAT A DASHBOARDS LOOK LIKE AND HOW TO SUSTAIN CONSISTENT MEASURES OVER TIME WILL BE CRITICAL TO KNOW IF WE ARE ACCOMPLISHING ANYTHING. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY. THANK YOU.

>> CITY CLERK: THAT'S IT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THAT'S OUR FINAL PUBLIC COMMENT, SO THANK YOU FOLKS FOR YOUR COMMENTS. I REALLY APPRECIATE IT. A LOT OF QUESTIONS THAT I WROTE DOWN THAT I AM SURE SOME OF THEM WILL GET ANSWERED AND IF NOT, I WILL TRY TO ANSWER THEM DURING MY TIME. WE WILL START WITH COUNCILMEMEBER TAPLIN. THESE ARE QUESTIONS AND COMMENTS. WE ARE MOVING IT TOGETHER BECAUSE WE DON'T HAVE ACTION IN THIS MEETING.

>> T. TAPLIN: WONDERFUL. THANK YOU SO MUCH, MADAM MAYOR, THANK

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YOU TO THE OFF THE STREETED AND HRT. I HAVE FOUR QUESTIONS. SOME OF THEM I GOT FROM THE OBVIOUS. I DID WANT TO ASK ABOUT MEASURE P. TO WHAT EXTENT HAVE MEASURE P DOLLARS BEEN AVAILABLE TO OR UTILIZED BY ORGANIZATIONS OR PROVIDERS -- I AM THINKING SPECIFICALLY OF THE HOUSE AND WOMEN'S AID AND DROP IN CENTER AND COMPARABLE PROGRAMS.

>> THE WOMEN'S DROP IN CENTER WERE FUNDED AS PART OF THE NEXUS FUNDING, WHICH WE TOOK SOME OF MEASURE P FUNDING TO PAY FOR PROGRAMS THAT HAVE HISTORICALLY BEEN HOMELESS PROGRAMMING. THAT IS NO LONGER THE CASE, BUT WE ARE STILL USING MEASURE P FUNDING FOR OTHER PROJECTS. CAN YOU PARSE OUT THE QUESTION A LITTLE BIT MORE? ARE YOU LOOKING BETWEEN FAMILIES AND SINGLE ADULTS?

>> T. TAPLIN: YEAH, IT'S KIND OF THE DEMOGRAPHIC ADJACENT QUESTIONS HOW ARE WE ABLE TO ASSESS THE PARTICULAR POPULATIONS THAT ARE BEING SERVED, AND HOW WE MIGHT BALANCE THE VARIOUS NEEDS OF THE UNHOUSED POPULATIONS.

>> STAFF: YEAH. FOR MEASURE P THE MAJORITY ARE SINGLE ADULT PROJECTS, AND SO WE ARE NOT SERVING MANY PROGRAMS THAT HAVE ANY FAMILY FUNDING. I CAN'T THINK OF ANY PROJECTS THAT ARE. GO AHEAD.

>> I WAS JUST GOING TO SAY THE REASON FOR THAT THE MAJORITY OF OUR HOMELESS POPULATION HAS DEMONSTRATED CONSISTENTLY IN THE POINT IN TIME COUNTS SINGLE ADULTS WITHOUT MINOR CHILDREN. AND

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DEFINITELY THE TRAUMA IS IN THE VERY REAL VIOLENCE THAT WOMEN ON THE STREETS EXPERIENCE ARE REAL. AS JOSH MENTIONED, WE USE GENERAL FUND TO SUPPORT AGENCIES LIKE THE WOMEN'S AID AND DROP-IN TO MAKE SURE THOSE ISSUES ARE ADDRESSED SPECIFICALLY. BUT, YOU KNOW, 2/3RD OF THE HOMELESS POPULATION IDENTIFIES AS MALE CONSISTENTLY, SO NOT TO MINIMIZE THE IMPORTANCE OF THAT, BUT JUST TO GIVE YOU A SENSE OF THE SCALE.

>> T. TAPLIN: SO YOU SAID GENERAL FUNDS FOR WOMEN'S AID AND DROP-IN CENTER?

>> YES, IT'S PART OF THE COMMUNITY AGENCY FUNDING.

>> T. TAPLIN: WONDERFUL. THAT'S A PRIORITY OF MINE. CAN WE LOOK AT THE SITE ACQUISITION SLIDE?

>> STAFF: YES, EXCUSE ME ONE SECOND. I WILL PULL IT UP.

>> T. TAPLIN: THE REASON WHY I AM CURIOUS IN THIS SLIDE IN PARTICULAR IS BECAUSE WE HEARD IN THE AUDITOR'S REPORT ABOUT THE REGIONAL NATURE OF HOMELESSNESS. AND WE ALSO HEARD FROM THE HRT PRESENTATION THAT THE CITY LACKS THE RESOURCES TO ESTABLISH A COMPLETELY NEW PROGRAM WITHOUT MAKING CUTS. SO GIVEN THAT WE ARE OPERATING IN PARTNERING TO RUN A NUMBER OF ALTERNATIVE HOUSING SITES, LEVERAGING A NUMBER OF FUNDS THAT WE ARE USING TO ACQUIRE UNITS, I DO WANT TO APPLAUD THE CITY FOR ACQUIRING THESE UNITS, AND SO MY QUESTION FOR -- MY QUESTION IN LIGHT OF THIS SLIDE IS TO WHAT EXTENT WOULD IT BE PURSUE TO INTERJURISDICTIONAL

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PARTNERSHIPS AND LARGER SCALE PROGRAMS SUCH AS A REGIONAL SAFE PROGRAM SOMETHING LIKE NOVATO CARES INSTEAD OF US TRYING TO DO EVERYTHING ON OUR OWN CONSIDERING THE LARGE NUMBER OF THINGS WE ARE DOING AND HOW VULNERABLE THESE PROGRAMS ARE WITH FUNDING LOSS. THANK YOU VERY MUCH. I WANT TO HIGHLIGHT THIS LIST AND APPLAUD THE WORK THAT COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI AND CITY MANAGER AND PETER AND EVERYBODY HAS DONE TO GET THESE THINGS ONLINE. AND I -- I WANT THERE TO BE MOW NO MYSTERY AROUND HOW HEAVY OF A LIST IT IS TO STAND THESE PROGRAMS UP.

>> STAFF: THANK YOU, COUNCILMEMBER. I APPRECIATE THAT. WITH RESPECT TO THE REGIONAL QUESTION, I WANT TO ACKNOWLEDGE THAT THAT'S A QUESTION THAT'S BEEN FORMALLY REFERRED TO US AS PART OF THE MAY 20TH REFERRAL FROM COUNCIL. AND SO WE ARE ACTIVELY WORKING ON KIND OF STRATEGIES AND RESPONSES TO THAT. RESPECTFULLY, I AM NOT QUITE PREPARED TO SPEAK TO THAT, BUT AS THE CITY MANAGER MENTIONED WE WILL BE RETURNING BACK TO COUNCIL IN OCTOBER WITH A RESPONSE TO THAT PORTION OF THE REFERRAL AND YOU CAN EXPECT SOME TREATMENT OF THAT QUESTION AT THAT TIME.

>> T. TAPLIN: THANK YOU VERY MUCH. MY NEXT QUESTION IS FOR THE CITY MANAGER. THIS IS IN LIGHT OF THE AUDIT RECOMMENDATIONS. SO TO THE EXTENT YOU ARE ABLE TO, I AM WONDERING IF WE CAN GET A FORECAST OF WHAT ADDITIONAL RESOURCES MIGHT BE NEEDED TO IMPLEMENT THE AUDIT'S RECOMMENDATIONS.

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>> STAFF: AS I SAID, WE HAD A LOT OF CONVERSATION WITH THE AUDITOR ABOUT THESE. I THINK WE ARE PREPARED TO MOVE FORWARD WITH THESE RECOMMENDATIONS WITH THE EXISTING RESOURCES THAT WE HAVE. WE ARE NOT ANTICIPATING NEEDING ADDITIONAL RESOURCES FOR THESE SPECIFIC RECOMMENDATIONS. AS WE GO INTO, LIKE, YOUR PREVIOUS QUESTION OR OTHER QUESTIONS AS IT RELATES TO EXPANDING THE SERVICES THAT ARE AVAILABLE, OBVIOUSLY, THAT WOULD NEED A LOT MORE RESOURCES AND THAT IS WHAT WE ARE ACTIVELY WORKING WITH THE COUNTY ON.

>> T. TAPLIN: THANK YOU VERY MUCH. AND THEN I WAS INTERESTED TO HEAR ABOUT THE OPTIONS OF THE WELLNESS TEAM. I AM WONDERING WHAT THE CITY COORDINATES WITH ENTITIES SUCH AS THAT? 72 WELL, I WANT TO ACKNOWLEDGE THAT WE HAVE REPRESENTATIVES FROM OUR HEALTH AND HOUSING SERVICES HERE AND THEY MANAGE THAT CONTRACT. I CAN TELL YOU THAT THEY HAVE BEEN WONDERFUL AND CRITICAL PARTNERS. WE PARTNER WITH THEM LITERALLY ON A DAILY BASIS AT PRIORITY ENCAMPMENTS TO CONNECT WITH PEOPLE, OFFER THEM RESOURCES, AND JUST MAKE SURE THAT WE ARE COORDINATING AND COLLABORATING. SO IF THERE ARE ANY MORE SPECIFIC QUESTIONS ABOUT THAT, I AM HAPPY TO DEFER OVER TO DIRECTOR GILMAN AND HIS TEAM.

>> T. TAPLIN: I WILL TAKE THEM OFFLINE, BUT I AM HAPPY TO HEAR THAT. IN CLOSING, I WANT TO RESPOND TO SOMETHING I HEARD DURING THE COMMENT PERIOD, RESPECTFULLY, I AM SURPRISED TO HEAR OUR

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COMPANIONS IN THE BUSINESS COMMUNITY TO HEAR THEM DISPARAGINGLY OUR HOTEL LEASE CONCERNING WHAT IS HITHERTO FOR -- HITHERTO FOR -- WHAT IS UP UNTIL NOW HAS BEEN CONSISTENT SUPPORT OF THE CITY'S INTERIM HOUSING SPEEDWAY AND AS A PERSON -- THESE PROGRAMS WE KNOW ARE EFFECTIVE UNTIL THE LEASE RUNS OUT AND WITH OUR STRUCTURAL DEFICIT WE MUST LEVERAGE EVERY DOLLAR OUTSIDE RESOURCES WHICH IS WHAT WE DID WITH HOME KEY. I WANT TO SHARE THAT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU FOR YOUR COMMENTS. MOVING ON TO COUNCILMEMBER TREGUB. I KNOW YOU HAVE A NUMBER OF QUESTIONS.

>> I. TREGUB: THANK YOU, MADAM MAYOR. I DID PROVIDE ADVANCE WARNING. I DO. FIRST, I WANTED TO ALSO EXPRESS MY PROFOUND GRATITUDE TO BOTH THE AUDITOR AND CITY STAFF. I STILL BELIEVE THAT ON A PER CAPITA BASIS, BERKELEY PUNCHES FAR AND WAY ABOVE ITS WEIGHT WHEN CONDUCTING HOMELESS RESPONSE EFFORTS. THESE CHALLENGES AS HAS BEEN MENTIONED BEFORE ARE ON A MACRO SCALE, AND ARE WORSENING. AND I JUST WANTED TO SHARE ONE JUST OF SEVERAL PERSONAL EXPERIENCES THAT I HAVE HAD BEING CONTACTED BY SOMEONE WHO WAS A SINGLE MOTHER WITH A -- WITH A YOUNG -- WITH SEVERAL YOUNG CHILDREN ESCAPING A BAD SITUATION FROM OUTSIDE OF BERKELEY, FOUND HERSELF IN BERKELEY AND ONLY TO REALIZE OF THE SIGNIFICANT BACKLOG OF RESOURCES, AND THANKFULLY, IT APPEARS SHE WAS ABLE TO GET INTO A SHELTER SOMEWHERE ELSE, BUT THAT EFFORT

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TOOK WEEKS, IF NOT MONTHS AND, YOU KNOW, INTERFACING WITH BOTH CITY STAFF, AND OUR NONPROFITS WHO DESPITE BEING COMPLETELY OVERWHELMED, PROVIDED THE BEST OF CARE AND SUPPORT AS BEST THEY COULD TO THIS ONE INDIVIDUAL. IT JUST SHOWS ME THE INCREDIBLE HEART OF THIS COMMUNITY. I WANTED -- I DID HAVE A FEW QUESTIONS. I WILL ASK THEM IN RAPID FIRE TO TRY TO SAVE TIME. OUR OFFICE, ALONG WITH THE REST OF THE COUNCIL, HAS TAKEN A DEEP AND CONCERTED EFFORT TO ENSURE THAT THE EXTENT THERE ARE GAPS BETWEEN CITY AND COUNTY INTERFACES, THAT THOSE ARE QUICKLY RESOLVED AND THAT THE CITY RECEIVES ITS FAIR SHARE OF THE FUNDING THAT IT DESERVES AND THAT WE ARE ALL PAYING INTO. TO THAT END, ONE QUESTION I HAD WAS THAT THAT GAP WHERE THE CITY, IF THERE IS EVEN AN INFINITESIMAL AMOUNT OF FUNDING THAT IT PROVIDES TO PROJECTS SUCH AS STEP UP HOUSING, THAT THE COUNTY DECIDES WHO IS ON THAT LIST, WHAT, IF ANYTHING, HAS BEEN AND CAN BE DONE TO ENSURE THAT THE SET IS IN A POSITION TO PRIORITIZE HOUSING FOR THOSE WHO HAVE BEEN DISPLACED OUT OF BERKELEY OR FIND THEMSELVES IN BERKELEY FOR AN EXTENDED PERIOD OF TIME. I WANTED TO UNDERSTAND THE STAFFING NUMBERS FOR THE HOMELESS RESPONSE TEAM. I BELIEVE THE AUDIT MENTIONED THAT THERE WAS ONE RETIREMENT, HOW MANY FTES ARE RIGHT NOW PAID FOR ARE THERE ANY HIRING ACTIONS TO THE EXTENT THERE ARE GAPS CURRENTLY. I WILL JUST HIGHLIGHT FROM THE REPORT, THE CITY'S LEGAL DEPARTMENT

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SPENDS 10 TO 40 HOURS PER WEEK PER ATTORNEY RIGHT NOW BASED ON THE SLEW OF LEGAL ACTIONS THAT ARE BEING, YOU KNOW, THAT ARE IN PROCESS AGAINST OR WHERE THE CITY IS THE DEFENDANT. I WANT TO KNOW WHAT PERCENTAGE OF TIME HRT STAFF SPENDS SITTING FOR DEPOSITIONS DOING OTHER THINGS THAT ARE RELATED TO LITIGATION THAT THEY ARE NOT ABLE TO SPEND ACTIVELY SERVING THE COMMUNITY AND ENSURING THAT RESOURCES ARE BEING PROVIDED.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THAT THAT WAS FINAL QUESTION?

>> I. TREGUB: IT IS NOT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: HOW MANY QUESTIONS DO YOU HAVE LEFT BECAUSE YOUR TIME IS UP AND I WANT TO BE RESPECTFUL. IT'S 5:34 AND WE HAVE THE REST OF THE COUNCILMEMBERS.

>> I. TREGUB: I WILL -- I WILL PICK TWO MORE THAT ARE MOST TOP OF MIND FOR ME.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY. I WILL GIVE YOU SOME OF MY TIME. GO AHEAD.

>> I. TREGUB: THANK YOU. THAT'S VERY KIND. I NOTICED THAT THERE IS A $1.3 MILLION BACK FILL THAT IS NEEDED TO MAKE UP FOR THE HHAP GAP. I WAS CURIOUS IF ANYTHING -- WELL, JUST IF STAFF WOULD UPDATE US ON RECENT ACTIONS AGAIN WITH THE COUNTY TO MAKE SURE WE GET OUR FAIR SHARE OF MEASURE W FUNDING AND FOR THE BENEFIT OF THE COMMUNITY WHAT CAN THEY DO TO LET THE COUNTY BOARD KNOW THE IMPORTANCE OF ENSURING THAT BERKELEY AND OTHER CITIES WITH

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THE HIGHEST NEED ARE GETTING THEIR FAIR SHARE. I ALSO, AND I WILL CLOSE HERE -- I THINK THE -- THE POINT IN TIME COUNTS PROVIDED BY THE DOWNTOWN BERKELEY ASSOCIATION TWICE A MONTH, THEY GO TO MY OFFICE, THEY HAVE BEEN VERY USEFUL IN TRACKING AND TRENDING THE NEED. I WAS CURIOUS IF THE CITY WOULD BE OPEN TO LEVERAGING SUCH EXISTING EFFORTS TO DO HOMELESSNESS COUNTS THAT ARE AT A GREATER FREQUENCY THAN WHAT STAFF IS ABLE TO COMMIT TO RIGHT NOW. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. I WILL HAVE THREE MINUTES AND 30 SECONDS FOR MY TIME. GO AHEAD.

>> STAFF: THANK YOU COUNCILMEMBER, I WILL ATTEMPT TO ANSWER IN RAPID FIRE AND OBVIOUSLY, HAPPY TO DISCUSS MORE OFFLINE IF YOU HAVE ANY FOLLOW UPS. SO WITH RESPECT TO THE QUESTION ABOUT REFERRALS AND HOUSING COMPREHENSIVE WITH THE LEVEL OF FUNDING, THAT'S AN ACTIVE POLICY QUESTION THAT WE ARE WORKING WITH THE COUNTY ON. I KNOW THE COUNTY EXPRESSED THEIR OPINION ON THAT POSITION. IN MAY OR JUNE THEY SENT A LETTER TO THE COUNTY EXPRESSING THAT WAS OUR POSITION. RIGHT NOW THE MEASURE W FUNDING AND HOW WE ROLL THAT OUT IS TAKING PRECEDENCE. OBVIOUSLY, WE WANT TO GET THAT FUNDING OUT THE DOOR QUICKLY, BUT WE ARE CONTINUING TO BANG OUR DRUM WITH THE PARTNERS AT THE COUNTY.

>> STAFF: I CAN ADD TO THAT QUICKLY. THE CITY MANAGERS

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REPRESENTING THE CITIES IN THE COUNTIES WROTE A SIMILAR LETTER EXPRESSING THE SAME CONCERN JUST SO YOU KNOW THAT.

>> STAFF: WITH RESPECT TO HOW MANY FTE WITHIN THE HOMELESS RESPONSE TEAM, CURRENTLY THERE ARE THREE AUTHORIZED FTE, TWO FILLED, ONE SUPERVISOR AND TWO OUTREACH WORKERS. THE COUNCIL BACK IN JUNE WITH THE ADOPTION OF THIS FISCAL YEAR'S BUDGET CREATED A THIRD SOCIAL SERVICE SPECIALIST OUTREACH WORKER. THE CITY IS IN THE PROCESS OF CONDUCTING INTERVIEWS AND HIRING FOR BOTH OF THOSE POSITIONS. WE JUST COMPLETED OUR FIRST ROUND. WE HAVE OUR SECOND ROUNDS OF INTERVIEWS I BELIEVE NEXT WEEK NEXT FRIDAY. THE PROCESS OF ACQUIRING NEW STAFF IS ACTIVELY UNDERWAY. WHAT PERCENTAGE OF STUFF THE STAFF SITS FOR LEGAL STUFF, I WILL SECOND THE OFF THE STREETED'S FINDING WE ESTIMATE IT AS ROUGHLY 10% OF OUR WEEKLY TIME. WITH RESPECT TO UPDATES TO MEASURE W FUNDING, YOU KNOW, JUST RESPECTFULLY TO THE COUNTY, I THINK THE BOARD OF SUPERVISORS ONLY VERY RECENTLY TOOK THAT BIG VOTE ON MEASURE W AND THAT WAS BACK IN JULY. AND SO, YOU KNOW, WE ARE CONTINUING TO WORK AND HAVE ALREADY HAD SEVERAL CITY-COUNTY MEETINGS TO DISCUSS KIND OF THE FRAMEWORK FOR ROLLING THAT OUT. I DON'T HAVE UNFORTUNATELY, ANY UPDATES BEYOND THAT. I CAN TELL YOU THE ONE RFP THAT THE COUNTY HAS ALREADY RELEASED FOR MEASURE W FUNDING WAS TO CREATE MORE INTERIM UNITS TO RESPOND ENCAMPMENTS, TO BE RESPONSIVE TO ENCAMPMENTS AND WE SPONSORED AN

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APPLICATION, AND, YOU KNOW, WE SUBMITTED THAT AND SO WE ARE JUMPING ON EVERY OPPORTUNITY. WITH RESPECT TO POINT IN TIME COUNTS, I THINK THIS MERITS A BIGGER DISCUSSION. IT IS -- WITH RESPECT TO THE AMOUNT OF WORK, YOU KNOW, THAT DBA DOES AND THAT'S A VERY HELPFUL COUNT FOR US TO RECEIVE AS WELL, I DO WANT TO ACKNOWLEDGE THAT, IT'S ONE THING TO TAKE ON A FEW BLOCKS IN THE DOWNTOWN AND IT'S ANOTHER THING TO TAKE ON EVERY NOOK AND CRANNY IN THE CITY. TO DO THAT FREQUENTLY IS A BIGGER LIFT THAN IT MAY SEEM NUMBER ONE. NUMBER TWO, WE NEED TO THINK VERY CAREFULLY ABOUT THE USEFULNESS IN DOING OUR OWN COUNT IN ADDITION TO THE BIANNUAL COUNTS THAT HAPPEN AT THE COUNTY LEVEL. THE POINTS OF THE COUNTS IS NOT JUST LOOK AT A POINT IN TIME, BUT LOOK AT TRENDS OVER TIME. IF WE DON'T HAVE THE SAME METHODOLOGIES, IT'S QUESTIONABLE TO THE EXTENT AT WHICH WE CAN COMPARE THE TRENDS OVER TIME WITH WHAT WE SEE AT THE COUNTY LEVEL. BUT I DO WANT TO ACKNOWLEDGE THAT THAT QUESTION IS A LEGITIMATE ONE AND, YOU KNOW, WE WOULD BE HAPPY TO ENGAGE IN FURTHER DISCUSSION.

>> I. TREGUB: THANK YOU SO MUCH.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. THAT WAS VERY EFFICIENT ANSWERING. I KNOW THERE ARE SOME FOLKS THAT ARE BRINGING THEIR KIDS BECAUSE WE HAVE A BRING OUR KIDS TO COUNCIL DAY, FOR FOLKS WHO JUST ARRIVED, WE ARE HAVING A SPECIAL MEETING ON HOMELESSNESS. WE

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HEARD A PRESENTATION FROM OUR HOMELESS RESPONSE TEAM AND WE ALSO HEARD ONE FROM OUR CITY AUDITOR, AND SO NOW OUR COUNCILMEMBERS ARE ASKING SOME QUESTIONS AND ALSO MAKING SOME COMMENTS ABOUT THOSE REPORTS. THAT IS SOME CONTEXT FOR WHAT IS GOING ON. MOVING ON, COUNCILMEMBER BLACKABY.

>> B. BLACKABY: THANK YOU, MADAM MAYOR AND THANKS TO THE STAFF FOR BEING HERE AND THE HOMELESS RESPONSE TEAM AND THE CITY AUDITOR'S OFFICE. IT WAS A USEFUL UPDATE AND I APPRECIATE THE TIME. AS THE CITY AUDITOR KNOWS I AM A BIG FAN OF METRICS AND GOALS AND OUTCOMES. WE HAVE HAD CONVERSATIONS ABOUT THAT, SO I APPRECIATED HER ATTENTION TO THAT IN THE AUDIT AND LOOK FORWARD TO KIND OF THINKING ABOUT HOW WE CAN APPLY SOME OF THAT OBVIOUSLY, TO THIS PARTICULAR PROBLEM, BUT THINKING ABOUT IT CITYWIDE IN A LOT OF THE WORK THAT WE ARE DOING. THAT'S SOMETHING AN INTERESTING OF MINE, BUT I THINK WILL HELP WITH TRANSPARENCY ACROSS THE BOARD. SO TO THAT END, YOU KNOW, WHEN WE THINK ABOUT THIS PARTICULAR ISSUE, HOW BIG, HOW THORNY, HOW COMPLICATED IT IS, COUNCILMEMEBER TAPLIN MAY APPRECIATE THE IDEA OF A GORDIAN KNOT FROM MYTHOLOGY, BUT IT'S SO DIFFICULT TO THINK ABOUT WHERE DO WE START? FOR ME THINKING ABOUT THE FRAMEWORK AND SOME OF THE GOALS THAT HELP US BREAK DOWN THE PROBLEM INTO BITE SIZES THAT HELP US THINK ABOUT HOW TO DO IT IS USEFUL. SO ONE THING I WAS KIND OF REFLECTING ON TONIGHT IF YOU BREAK DOWN THE

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WHOLE PROBLEM MAYBE INTO THREE PIECES AND MAYBE THIS ISN'T THE RIGHT FRAMEWORK, BUT CURIOUS TO WORK WITH YOU OVER TIME AS TO WHAT THAT MIGHT BE, BUT ONE GOAL IS A MINIMUM IS JUST IF YOU LOOK AT THE DATA, TO MAKE SURE THAT EVERYONE WHO IS HOMELESS HAD SOME SORT OF FORM OF SHELTER. RIGHT NOW WE ARE AT 47% SHELTERED AND 844 PEOPLE ARE UNHOUSED, SO, YOU KNOW, HOW MUCH OF WHAT WE ARE DOING CAN WE DRIVE THAT NUMBER FROM 40% SHELTERED TO WHAT WE CAN JUST AT A MINIMUM TO GET A NUMBER FOR THE PROBLEM AND WHAT ARE THE INITIATIVES WE ARE DOING THERE? MAYBE A SECOND GOAL FOR THE SAKE OF ARGUMENT IS DRIVING THE TOTAL NUMBER OF OUR UNHOUSED NUMBER AS CLOSE TO ZERO AS WE CAN. I KNOW THAT'S IMPOSSIBLE. BUT THINK ABOUT GET EVERYONE IN A SHELTER AS MINIMUM AND SLIM THE POPULATION DOWN TO ZERO IF POSSIBLE, WHAT ARE THE THINGS WE ARE DOING TO ADDRESS THAT? THREE, IT'S ONCE YOU PLUGGED THE BUCKET, MAKE SURE YOU ARE NOT ADDING MORE TO THE BUCKET, HOW DO WE PRESENT HOMELESSNESS HAPPENING IN THE FIRST PLACE? SO AT LEAST IN MY MIND TAKING THE BIG PROBLEM AND BREAKING IT DOWN I AM NOT SAYING THOSE ARE THE RIGHT THREE PIECES, BUT FOR ME THAT'S A USEFUL WAY ESPECIALLY IF WE HAVE TO MAKE TOUGH DECISIONS IN THE MONTHS AHEAD AND MAKING TRADEOFFS UNDERSTANDING IF WE ARE PUTTING MORE IN ONE BUCKET THAN THE OTHER, THAT'S THE TRADEOFF. THAT HELPS ME BREAK THAT PROBLEM DOWN AND AS WE GOING FORWARD WOULD HELP TO UNPACK THAT AT LEAST FOR ME IN A PROBLEM SOLVING

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PERSPECTIVE. AND THEN ON THE REPORT ITSELF, AGAIN, THANK YOU FOR THE MEMO, ONE JUST COMMENT WAS LOOKING AT THE FY25 SPENDING VERSUS FY26. I KNOW WE SPENT ABOUT $25 MILLION IN FY25. YOU MENTIONED IN FY26, WE ARE POISED TO SPEND ABOUT 19. EVEN WITHOUT THE FUTURE FISCAL CLIFF WE ARE THINKING ABOUT, IT LOOKS LIKE WE ARE SEEING PRETTY BIG CUTS. IS THAT ACCURATE AND DO YOU A PERSPECTIVE ON WHAT THAT WILL MEAN FOR SERVICES IN THE COMING YEAR JUST WITH THOSE NUMBERS?

>> STAFF: YEAH, I THINK ONE OF THE IMPACTS MAKING HARD DECISIONS AROUND MEASURE P WASN'T PULLING IN THE SAME REVENUE WE HAD SEEN PREVIOUSLY, AND SO WE HAD TO MAKE SOME DECISIONS, WE DEFINITELY COULDN'T FUND NEW PROGRAMMING, AND THEN WE ALSO HAD TO START LOOKING AT WHAT WE COULD CUT AND MAKE SOME CUTS. SO IT JUST -- THE NATURE OF MEASURE P BECAUSE IT'S A TAX, AND IT'S BOTTLE AND NOT PREDICTABLE BASED ON WHO MAKES PURCHASES ON PROPERTY THAT YEAR, IT'S HARD TO KNOW.

>> STAFF: I WAS GOING TO ADD, TOO BECAUSE ONE OF THE THINGS THAT JOSH MENTIONED IN THE PRESENTATION THE ONE-TIME NATURE IN A LOT OF THE FUNDING THAT AT WE ARE GETTING FROM THE STATE, THOSE ARE COMING IN BLOCK GRANTS THAT ARE, YOU KNOW, $5 MILLION AT A TIME THROUGH THE YEAR F THAT WE HAVE BEEN GETTING. AS WE SPEND THOSE DOWN, THOSE WILL KIND OF DISAPPEAR FROM OUR BALANCE SHEET, AND SO THE FLUCTUATION YEAR IN AND YEAR OUT IS PARTIALLY

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ATTRIBUTABLE TO THE SHIFTING FUNDING SOURCES.

>> B. BLACKABY: ONE WAY TO THINK ABOUT IT IS PART OF THE BUDGET CAPITAL INVESTMENT ON THINGS THAT ARE LONG-TERM LIKE PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING VERSUS OPERATIONAL TO KEEP THINGS RUNNING. IF WE DON'T HAVE MONEY TO INVEST IN BIG NEW PROJECTS FROM YEAR TO YEAR, THAT'S ONE THING. IF WE ARE LOSING OPERATIONAL FUNDING, THEN THAT MIGHT SUGGEST WE MIGHT HOUSE FEWER PEOPLE THAN WE CURRENTLY ARE. THAT'S WHAT I AM TRYING TO UNWRAP OBVIOUSLY. WHAT DOES IT MEAN THE DEMOCRATIC OF $7 MILLION LOSS IN EXPECTED SPENDING.

>> STAFF: IT MEANS THE LATTER. IT KEEPS THE LIGHTS ON ON THESE PROGRAMS.

>> B. BLACKABY: ONE LAST QUESTION. YOU ARE TALKING ABOUT THE PIPELINE. WHAT DOES IT MEAN FOR THE UNITS TO BE IN THE PIPELINE AND WHAT KIND OF INVESTMENT IS STILL REQUIRED TO MOVE THINGS FROM THE PIPELINE TO ACTUALLY GET THEM INTO OPERATION.

>> STAFF: THANK YOU FOR THAT QUESTION. I AM GOING TO DEFER TO MARGOT OUR MANAGER OF COMMUNITY SERVICES FOR THAT ONE.

>> B. BLACKABY: THANK YOU.

>> STAFF: SURE, YEAH. TYPICALLY, IF WE REFER TO IT AS BEING IN THE PIPELINE, HASN'T YET BEEN FULLY CONSTRUCTED. SO SOME OF THOSE PROJECTS MIGHT BE UNDER CONSTRUCTION AND ALREADY HAVE THEIR FINANCING, AND SO THEN THERE IS NOTHING NEEDED, JUST THE

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TIME THAT IT TAKES TO FINISH THE PROJECT. ONES THAT ARE EARLIER IN THE PROCESS AND HAVE LIKE A CITY COMMITMENT, BUT IT STILL ASSEMBLING THEIR FINANCING AND WE DO HAVE A LOT OF PROJECTS THAT ARE IN THAT SITUATION, LIKE THE PROJECTS THAT WE APPROVED LIKE NORTH BERKELEY BART THAT HAVE GOTTEN ENTITLED AND HAVE CITY FUNDING, BUT THEY ARE STILL WORKING TO ASSEMBLE THE REST OF THEIR FINANCING, SO THAT'S THE MAIN THING FOR THOSE IT'S TIME AND GOING THROUGH THE ROUNDS WITH THE STATE. THEY DO SOMETIMES COME BACK TO US AT THE END TO GET ADDITIONAL FUNDING TO FILL THE GAP. SO THERE MIGHT BE AN ASK OF US AT THAT POINT, AND THEN ONES THAT ARE EVEN EARLIER IN THE PROCESS THAT MAYBE ARE NOT EVEN ENTITLED, THEY STILL HAVE TO GO THROUGH OUR NIGHTTIME PROCESS AND GET THEIR FINANCING.

>> B. BLACKABY: BECAUSE WHAT'S APPEALING TO ME IS PUTTING THE NUMBERS TOGETHER. WE HAVE 844 UNHOUSED POPULATION, IS THIS ACTUALLY GOING TO HELP US CLOSE THE GAP THAT WE CURRENTLY OBSERVE? IS THAT REALISTIC TO THINK ABOUT?

>> STAFF: I DON'T THINK THE 1200 IS REFERRING TO PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING.

>> B. BLACKABY: 220 PERM NEGATIVE SUPPORTIVE AND THEN 1200 OTHERWISE.

>> STAFF: YEAH, THE PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING UNITS WILL BE THE BEST ENTRY POINT FOR PEOPLE WHO ARE TRANSITIONING FROM BEING

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UNHOUSED INTO BEING HOW'S THE. IT'S STILL QUITE A WAYS AWAY FOR THE UNITS TO BE CONSTRUCTED AND THEN LEASED UP. WE DO HAVE OUR PREFERENCE POLICY THAT WE APPLY, BUT OUTSIDE OF THAT, THERE ISN'T A GUARANTEE THAT IT'S GOING TO GO SPECIFICALLY TO AN UNHOUSED BERKELEY HOUSEHOLD.

>> B. BLACKABY: GREAT. MY TIME IS UP. THANK YOU EVERYONE FOR THEIR WORK. IF WE TAKE THE PROBLEM INTO THE COMPONENT PARTS AND LOOK AT THE PIECES THAT WE ARE ADDING AND LOOK AT THE MATH AND UNDERSTAND HOW DOES THIS ALL FIT IN CONTEXT WOULD HELP ME AS A POLICYMAKER. THANK YOU MAYOR AND THANKS TO THE STAFF.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOUS VERY MUCH. COUNCILMEMBER O'KEEFE.

>> S. O'KEEFE: THANK YOU, MAYOR. I HAVE TWO QUESTIONS FOR PETER. THANK YOU FOR JOINING US AGAIN. I WAS REALLY GLAD TO HEAR IN A PREVIOUS ANSWER THAT YOU ARE NOT ONLY FILLING THE NEW POSITION, BUT BACK FILLING. YOU ARE GETTING TWO NEW STAFFERS, CORRECT.

>> STAFF: CORRECT. THOSE EFFORTS ARE UNDERWAY.

>> S. O'KEEFE: THAT'S GREAT. I WAS WONDERING TO THE EXTENT LACK OF STAFF HAS BEEN A BOTTLENECK TO ACHIEVE YOUR WORK? WHAT HAS BEEN A BOTTLENECK AND WHAT CHANGES DO YOU EXPECT ONCE THE TWO STAFF ARE FULLY ONBOARDED.

>> STAFF: I COUGHED AT AN INOPPORTUNE TIME.

>> S. O'KEEFE: STAPH RESOURCES, HOW CAN THAT CHANGE YOUR LIFE.

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>> STAFF: THANK YOU FOR THAT QUESTION. IT WILL HELP US BE MORE RESPONSIVE TO THE ENCAMPMENTS ON THE STREET IN TERMS OF ENGAGING WITH PEOPLE, MAKING HOUSING ASSESSMENTS AND MAKING SHELTER BEDS WHEREVER AVAILABLE AND CONNECTING PEOPLE TO RESOURCES AND SERVES. IT WON'T HELP WITH THE OTHER ASPECT OF THE HRT'S WORK, WHICH IS KIND OF MANAGING CLEANUPS. WE RELY HEAVILY ON STAFF FROM THE PUBLIC WORKS, AND PARKS DEPARTMENT AND THEIR EQUIPMENT, YOU KNOW, POLICE 1 NECESSARY WHEN NECESSARY FOR WORKERS SAFETY AND THINGS OF THAT NATURE, AND SO I WOULDN'T ANTICIPATE THAT HAVING MORE -- HAVING MORE STAFF IN NEIGHBORHOOD SERVICES OUTREACH WILL HELP THE PACE WITH THAT BECAUSE IT WON'T. HOWEVER, YOU KNOW, OUR GOAL IS TO TRY TO JUST BE MORE RESPONSIVE TO CONNECT PEOPLE TO RESOURCES SO THAT WE ADVOCATE TO DO AS MANY AS THOSE OPERATIONS.

>> S. O'KEEFE: GOOD ANSWER. THANK YOU SO MUCH. I HAVE A COMMENT. JUST GOING BACK TO THE BEGINNING I JUST REALLY WANT TO THANK ALL OF YOU FOR THE REALLY INFORMATIVE PRESENTATION, BUT I ALSO WANT TO THANK YOU, SPECIFICALLY THE HRT TEAM, I REALLY WANT TO THANK YOU FOR THE WORK THAT YOU DO. COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI ALREADY ACKNOWLEDGED THIS EARLIER, BUT IT'S GOT TO BE REALLY THANKLESS SOMETIMES AND IT'S HARD WORK. AND IT'S ALSO, LIKE, SOME OF THE MOST IMPORTANT WORK THAT WE DO IN THE CITY FROM A MORAL PERSPECTIVE, AND I JUST WANT YOU GUYS TO KNOW THAT WE SEE

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THAT. I SEE THAT. I THINK WE ALL DO AND I JUST WANTED TO HIGHLIGHT THAT. IT'S REALLY IMPORTANT WORK AND IT'S HARD AND THANK YOU SO MUCH FOR DOING IT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANKS, COUNCILMEMBER. COUNCILMEMBER HUMBERT.

>> M. HUMBERT: THANK YOU, MADAM MAYOR. I CUT DOWN MY NUMBER OF QUESTIONS AND I WILL ARTICULATE THEM IN A SERIES IN A GESTALT. THEY ARE ALL PRETTY RELATED, THE ONES I HAVE LEFT AND LET WHOEVER MIGHT WANT TO ANSWER THEM ANSWER. BUT FIRST, I WANT TO THANK PETER RADU, EVERYONE ON THE HOMELESS RESPONSE TEAM. AUDITOR WONG AND HER STAFF. I TRULY APPRECIATE ALL THE WORK DONE BY THE HOMELESS RESPONSE TEAM AS COUNCILMEMBER O'KEEFE SAID, YOU HAVE A REALLY DIFFICULT JOB AND IT'S MADE ALL THE MORE FRUSTRATING BY A LACK OF RESOURCES. YOUR JOB COULD BE DESCRIBED AS SISYPHEAN. I THINK IT IS, BUT WE COULD NOT HAVE MADE THE PROGRESS ON HOMELESSNESS WITHOUT YOU AND IT'S PROGRESS THAT, YOU KNOW, COMPARES FAVORABLY TO ANY OTHER CITY AROUND HERE. TO AUDITOR WONG AND HER TEAM, I AM REALLY GRATEFUL WE HAVE A NATIONALLY AWARDED AND DEEPLY DEDICATED AUDITOR'S OFFICE. IN MANY WAYS YOU ARE THE COUNCIL'S EYES AND EARS FOR ISSUES WE MIGHT NOT BE AWARE OF OR IN THE BANDWIDTH TO DIVE INTO. HERE ARE MY QUESTIONS AND THEY ALL KIND OF RELATE TO THE INTERFACE, THE CONNECTIONS WE HAVE BETWEEN THE CITY AND THE COUNTY IN PROVIDING HOMELESS SERVICES. I WILL SPIT THEM OUT AND LET YOU KIND OF

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RESPOND TO THEM GLOBALLY. I WANT TO UNDERSTAND WHAT SHELTER SERVICES AND RESOURCES THE CITY IS PUTTING MONEY INTO THAT ARE ULTIMATELY CONTROLLED BY THE COUNTY? HOW THE COUNTY'S CONTROL, HOW DOES IT AFFECT OUR ABILITY TO FOCUS OUR LOCAL SHELTERS AND RESOURCES ON THOSE WHO ARE UNHOUSED IN OUR OWN CITY? WHAT MECHANISMS DO WE HAVE TO INFLUENCE COUNTY DECISIONS OR OTHERWISE EXERCISE MORE LOCAL CONTROL TO ENSURE THAT THE RESOURCES ARE BEING DIRECTED IN A MANNER COMMENSURATE WITH OUR HIGH LEVEL OF INVESTMENT AND THEN THE SIGNIFICANT OF PROPORTIONATE UNHOUSED PEOPLE COMING FROM OUTSIDE THE CITY. DO WE HAVE AN ESTABLISHED PROCESSES AND PROCEDURES FOR WHEN A CITY DEPARTMENT FINDS THEY ARE FACING A ROADBLOCK WITH COUNTY GOVERNMENT? IS THERE A CLEAR LINE OF COMMUNICATION FROM DEPARTMENT HEADS OR THE CITY MANAGER'S OFFICE TO COUNTY LEVEL STAFF? IS THERE A PROTOCOL FOR WHEN COUNCILMEMBERS OR STATE REPS GET INVOLVED TO TRY TO MOVE THINGS ALONG? THERE ARE TWO CLUSTERS THERE. ONE MAYBE FOR PETER PRIMARILY AND THE OTHER FOR OUR CITY MANAGER AND THAT'S WHAT I HAVE.

>> STAFF: THANKS, COUNCILMEMBER. SO WITH RESPECT TO YOUR FIRST QUESTION ABOUT SHELTER, I THINK SPECIFICALLY, THAT'S CONTROLLED BY THE COUNTY. I WANT TO MAYBE CHANGE THE TERMINOLOGY A LITTLE BIT. I WOULDN'T SAY SO MUCH CONTROLLED BY THE COUNTY AS, YOU KNOW, THE REFERRALS INTO THAT ARE SORT OF CHANNELED THROUGH THE

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COORDINATED ENTRY PROCESS INSOFAR AS WE HAVE GOT TO MAKE SURE THOSE BEDS ARE AVAILABLE FOR ANYBODY THAT'S TRYING TO GET A BED THROUGH THAT COORDINATED ENTRY PROCESS. SO THE DISTINCTION IS PROBABLY MORE ABOUT JUST DIRECTNESS OF REFERRALS, SO FOR THE NON-CONGREGATE AND THOSE BEDS THAT ARE FULLY FUNDED BY THE CITY WHERE WE DON'T DRAW DOWN ANY COUNTY FUNDING OR COUNTY PAST DUE FUNDING, WE DIRECTLY CONTROL THOSE REFERRALS. THE HOMELESS RESPONSE TEAM COMPETING, BUT FOR LACK OF A BETTER WORD COMPETING WITH REFERRALS INTO THAT VACANT BED. THAT'S NOT THE CASE FOR THE MAJORITY OF BEDS POINTED OUT IN THE GRAPH IN THE AUDITOR'S REPORT. IT'S NOT TO SAY THAT THEY ARE NOT AVAILABLE TO US. THEY ARE JUST NOT GUARANTEED, AND SO THAT MAKES IT CHALLENGING TO MATCH THE SHELTER RESOURCES TO PEOPLE WHEN WE ENGAGE WITH ENCAMPMENTS OVER THE COURSE OF DAYS, WEEKS, OR MONTHS BECAUSE AT ANY GIVEN TIME THE BEDS CAN COME AND GO AND IT'S HARD TO SORT OF LINE UP THOSE VACANCIES TO BE ABLE TO DO THAT OUTREACH. I THINK THAT'S RESPONSIVE TO YOUR QUESTION HOW THAT IMPACTS OUR ABILITY TO PROVIDE SHELTER FOR PEOPLE. WITH RESPECT TO THE MECHANISMS FOR KIND OF THE CITY-COUNTY INTERFACE ON CHANGING THAT POLICY, YOU KNOW, I THINK THE BIGGER POLICY QUESTION AT THIS TIME THAT WE ARE REALLY TRYING TO ENGAGE WITH THE COUNTY ON IS THE ONE ABOUT PERMANENT HOUSING AND MAKING SURE THAT REFERRALS ARE COMMENSURATE WITH THE LEVEL OF FUNDING THAT WE PROVIDE OR LEVEL

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OF LOCAL EFFORT, AND SO THAT'S KIND OF THE QUESTION OF THE DAY THAT WE ARE ENGAGING WITH THE COUNTY ON. WITH RESPECT TO THE SHELTER REFERRAL PIECE, I WOULD JUST STRESS THAT THE MAJORITY OF THE BEDS THAT ARE SUBJECT TO THIS COORDINATED ENTRY PROCESS ARE CONGREGATE BEDS. AND I THINK THE BIGGER FACTOR IN THE EQUATION HERE IS THE ONE THAT JOSH POINTED OUT IN THE PRESENTATION IS THAT THOSE BEDS JUST AREN'T AS USEFUL IN TERMS OF MOVING PEOPLE INSIDE. FOLKS ARE NOT ACCEPTING THOSE AT THE SAME RATE AND MOVING INTO THOSE AT THE SAME RATE. AND SO I THINK OUR EFFORT RIGHT NOW IS TO MAKE SURE WITH THE COUNTY WE ARE DOING EVERYTHING WE CAN TO MAKE SURE THAT THE DOLLARS THAT WE PUT IN ARE HELPING DRIVE DOWN OUR LOCAL HOMELESS POPULATION FOR PERMANENT HOUSING, AND THEN TRYING TO DO WHATEVER WE CAN TO DRAW DOWN MORE RESOURCES, LIKE, THE RECENT MEASURE RFP THAT I MENTIONED EARLIER TO TRY TO BRING ON MORE OF THESE NON-CONGREGATE THAT WE CAN DIRECTLY CONTROL REFERRALS INTO. I HOPE THAT MAKES SENSE. I THINK THERE MIGHT HAVE BEEN A QUESTION FOR THE CITY MANAGER AS WELL.

>> STAFF: I CAN TAG ON BRIEFLY WHAT PETER JUST SAID IF THINGS GET STUCK WITH THE COUNTY OR TRYING TO FIGURE SOMETHING OUT WITH THEM. THE COUNTY IS A HUGE BUREAUCRACY, OBVIOUSLY. THE HOMELESS SERVICES, BOTH POLICIES AND FUNDING FLOWS THROUGH THE HEALTH DEPARTMENT AND, YOU KNOW, BOTH PETER AND I HAVE GOOD

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RELATIONSHIPS WITH THE STAFF AT THE HEALTH DEPARTMENT. I WAS TEXTING WITH THE HEALTH DEPARTMENT DIRECTOR TODAY FROM THE COUNTY ABOUT SOME THINGS AND PETER KNOWS THE STAFF THERE VERY WELL. SO IT'S EASY FOR US TO BE IN CONVERSATION WITH THEM, BUT KNOWING THEY ARE ONLY A PART THIS WHOLE BIG SYSTEM THAT GOVERNS HOW THE MONEY GETS SPENT AND THE POLICIES GET PUT FORWARD. I KNOW MANY OF YOU AND I HAVE GOOD RELATIONSHIPS WITH SOME OF THE SUPERVISORS THERE, SO THAT'S ALSO HELPFUL.

>> B. BLACKABY: THAT'S ALL I HAD.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU SO MUCH. I KNOW WE HAD A LOT OF FOLKS TO ENTER EXPECTING THE 6:00 MEETING TO START AND WE ARE RUNNING LATE. I JUST WANT TO GIVE FOLKS A HEADS UP ON THAT. WE HAVE FOUR FOLKS WHO HAVE COMMENTS TO MAKE OR QUESTIONS, AND SO WE WILL DO THAT TO COMPLETE OUR HOMELESSNESS SPECIAL MEETING. I KNOW WE HAD A BIG GROUP OF FOLKS WALK IN. GO AHEAD, COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI.

>> R. KESARWANI: THANK YOU, MADAM MAYOR. THANK YOU AGAIN TO THE HOMELESS RESPONSE TEAM AND THE AUDITOR'S OFFICE FOR THE PRESENTATIONS. I KNOW I THANKED YOU BEFORE FOR THE INCREDIBLE WORK THAT'S BEING DONE EVERY DAY IN OUR COMMUNITY TO ADDRESSING ENCAMPMENTS. AND I HEARD EARLIER ABOUT COST. I THINK THERE WAS A SLIDE SHOWN, SO I JUST WANTED TO CIRCLE BACK THAT THE COST IS ON THE ORDER OF MILLIONS, TYPICALLY, $5 TO $10 MILLION FOR SEVERAL YEARS. WE SAW THAT GRAPH OF HOW OUR FUNDING SOURCES ARE GOING TO

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DROP OFF SO WE HAVE TO PLAN AHEAD HOW WE CAN USE RESOURCES LIKE THE MEASURE W COUNTY FUNDS TO BACKFILL THAT LOSS OF FUNDING THAT WE HAVEN'T PLANNED FOR, INERTIA, TO KEEP THESE RESOURCES OPEN AND AVAILABLE FOR FOLKS WHO NEED THEM. I DID WANT TO ASK YOU; I THINK COUNCILMEMBER HUMBERT TOUCHED ON THE ISSUE OF ENTRY LEVEL PLACEMENTS. WHEN WE HAVE PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING, I WANT THE PUBLIC TO UNDERSTAND HOW ARE PLACEMENTS MADE INTO THAT? I THINK YOU TALKED ABOUT HOW WE PLACE INTO THE TRANSITIONAL MOTELS, BUT HOW DOES IT DIFFER WITH PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING IN TERMS OF PLACEMENTS?

>> STAFF: THANKS COUNCILMEMBER, GOOD QUESTION. PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING IS KIND OF A UNIQUE INTERVENTION FROM THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT PERSPECTIVE BECAUSE IT HAS SOME VERY SPECIFIC HUD REQUIREMENTS THAT ARE ATTACHED TO IT. AND THEN HUD ALSO, THE DEPARTMENT OF HOUSING AND URBAN DEVELOPMENT, ALSO KIND OF DELEGATES DOWN TO THE LEVEL OF CONTINUUM OF COUNTY AT ALAMEDA COUNTY AND THAT'S KIND OF THE COUNTY LEVEL ON MAKING OTHER DECISIONS. WHAT'S NOT UP FOR DISCUSSION LOCALLY IS THE FACT THAT PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING BY FEDERAL REGULATION HAS TO BE PRIORITIZED TO PEOPLE WHO ARE CHRONICALLY HOMELESS AND HIGHLY VULNERABLE. AND THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT DEFINES CHRONIC HOMELESSNESS AND IT ALSO GIVES SOME GUIDELINES FOR CONTINUUMS OF CARE ON THINGS THAT CAN BE CONSIDERED WHEN DEFINING

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VULNERABILITY LOCALLY. THOSE GUIDELINES ON DEFINING VULNERABILITY, I THINK, ARE VERY IMPORTANT AND, YOU KNOW, SHOULD BE TAKEN UNDER CLOSE ADVISEMENT, BUT THERE IS A LOT OF VARIABILITY IN TERMS OF HOW A CONTINUUM OF CARE PRIORITIZES PEOPLE FOR PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING. WHAT DOES THAT LOOK LIKE IN PRACTICE HERE? WE HAVE A HOUSING ASSESSMENT WHERE BECAUSE WE DON'T HAVE ENOUGH OF THIS RESOURCE TO GO TO EVERYBODY WHO MAY POTENTIALLY NEED IT, WE WANT TO MAKE SURE THAT PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING, WHICH IS THE MOST INTENSIVE RESOURCE, IS GOING TO THE PEOPLE WHO NEED IT THE MOST. THE WAY THAT WE DO THAT IS THROUGH A PRIORITIZATION PROCESS. WE ASK A SERIES OF QUESTIONS THAT TO THE BEST WE CAN QUANTIFY KIND OF HOW NEEDY ARE YOU? THE COUNTY HAS A PROCESS THAT IDENTIFIES PEOPLE WHO ARE IN A PRIORITY POOL AND PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING IS MATCHED FROM THAT POOL. IT'S VERY WONKY. I AM HAPPY TO DISCUSS MORE IF YOU HAVE ANY QUESTIONS, BUT THAT GIVES A HIGH LEVEL OVERVIEW. IT'S PRIORITIZED AND RATIONED IN A WAY BECAUSE DEMAND IS FAR EXCEEDING SUPPLY. [INDISCERNIBLE].

>> MAYOR ISHII: MIC.

>> R. KESARWANI: THANK YOU MR. RADU FOR YOUR ANSWER THERE. I THINK A KEY TAKEAWAY HERE IS THAT THE COUNTY IS MAKING THOSE PLACEMENTS, AND SO PEOPLE WHO ARE UNSHELTERED WHO MEET A HIGH LEVEL OF PRIORITY FOR PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING, IF THEY ARE

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UNSHELTERED IN BERKELEY, THEY MAY BE PLACED IN BERKELEY OR ELSEWHERE IN THE COUNTY. SIMILARLY PEOPLE WHO ARE UNSHELTERED IN OTHER PARTS OF THE COUNTY IF THEY ARE MEETING THE PRIORITY, THEY MAY BE PLACED IN BERKELEY. I THINK THAT'S THE CHALLENGE WHEN WE LOOK AT OUR COUNT AND NUMBER OF UNITS IN THE PIPELINE OVER PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING, WE DON'T HAVE DIRECT CONTROL. I THINK WE SHOULD BE CHAMPIONING PERMANENT SUPPORTIVE HOUSING BECAUSE IT'S SOLUTION. OTHER JURISDICTIONS ARE MAKING SIMILAR COMMITMENTS KNOWING WE WILL ALL BENEFIT FROM IT. OF COURSE, OUR TRADITIONAL MOTELS, I THINK THAT IS VERY IMPORTANT FOR US TO KEEP FUNDING BECAUSE IT'S A TOOL THAT WE DO HAVE DIRECT CONTROL OVER THE PLACEMENTS. WE HAVE USED THOSE, I WANT THE PUBLIC TO KNOW, 2ND STREET, WHEN YOU ARE GOING DOWN CEDAR TO GET ON THE FREEWAY ON GILMAN ON OUR BEAUTIFUL NEW ROUNDABOUTS, IF YOU LOOK DOWN 2ND STREET, IN THE PAST YOU WOULD HAVE SEEN BROKEN DOWN RVS AND TENTS AND PEOPLE WHO ARE UNSHELTERED IN THAT AREA AND WE WERE ABLE TO OFFER MOTEL ROOMS, I BELIEVE THE CAPRI MOTEL TO EVERYBODY WHO WAS THERE. WE DID RV BUY BACK IN THAT AREA, TOO. PEOPLE WERE COMPENSATED FOR GIVING UP THEIR RV. I THINK THIS MODEL HAS BEEN PROVEN VERY SUCCESSFUL. PEOPLE ARE STILL INDOORS. THAT STREET HAS BEEN CLEARED, AND IT HASN'T BEEN SORT OF REPOPULATED. SO BUT IT'S ALL A MATTER OF RESOURCES. YOU KNOW, THE MOTEL ROOM, THE MULTI IS MULTIMILLION DOLLAR INVESTMENT. THE

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RV BUY BACK, WAS IT $175 PER LINEAR FOOT.

>> STAFF: CORRECT.

>> R. KESARWANI: THAT'S ROUGHLY $5,000 OR SO PER RV, BUT THAT IS WHAT WE FOUND WAS EFFECTIVE IN GETTING PEOPLE TO RELINQUISH THE BROKEN DOWN INOPERABLE VEHICLE AND COME INDOORS. AND I WANT TO ACKNOWLEDGE WE HAVE RVS IN OTHER PARTS OF WEST BERKELEY AND I HOPE WE CAN USE THAT MODEL. IT'S A RESOURCE QUESTION FOR US AND WE ARE ADVOCATING VERY STRONGLY WITH THE COUNTY TO RECEIVE MEASURE W FUNDS SO WE CAN DO MORE OF WHAT WE KNOW WORKS, SO THANK YOU AGAIN FOR ALL OF THE WORK. THANK YOU FOR THE AUDIT, AND I LOOK FORWARD TO OUR CONTINUED PROGRESS IN THIS AREA.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. AGAIN, I KNOW WE HAD A LOT MORE FOLKS JUST WALK IN. WE ARE RUNNING LATE FROM OUR PREVIOUS MEETING THAT STARTED AT 4. IF YOU ARE HERE FOR BRING YOUR KIDS TO COUNCIL DAY, WE ARE WRAPPING UP OUR HOMELESSNESS SPECIAL MEETING, WHICH WE HAD A PRESENTATION EARLIER AND NOW WE ARE TAKING QUESTIONS AND COMMENTS FROM OUR COUNCILMEMBERS. I THINK WE JUST HAVE THREE FOLKS LEFT. COUNCILMEMBER LUNAPARRA.

>> C. LUNAPARRA: THANK YOU. I WILL BE BRIEF. I WANT TO THANK THE HRT FOR ALL OF YOUR WORK. I KNOW THIS IS EXTREMELY DIFFICULT AND I KNOW YOUR TEAM IS WHOLEHEARTEDLY COMMITTED TO IT. THANK YOU SO MUCH. I ALSO WANT TO THANK YOU AUDITOR JENNY WONG AND HER STAFF'S DEDICATED AND THOROUGH WORK. THANK YOU SO MUCH. THIS IS

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REALLY IMPORTANT AS WELL. I HAVE ONE QUESTION THAT I KNOW CAN'T BE ANSWERED RIGHT NOW, BUT IT'S SOMETHING THAT I WOULD BE INTERESTED TO SEE IN THE FUTURE THAT SOME COMMUNITY MEMBERS BROUGHT UP ABOUT THE COST OF THE ENCAMPMENT CLOSURES AND ENCAMPMENT SWEEPS. AND HOW MANY RESOURCES THAT UTILIZES EVERY TIME THAT WE CONDUCT ONE? BUT YEAH, I KNOW THAT'S NOT POSSIBLE TO ANSWER RIGHT NOW, SO THANK YOU SO MUCH FOR THE PRESENTATIONS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY. THANK YOU. COUNCILMEMBER BARTLETT.

>> B. BARTLETT: THANK YOU, MADAM MAYOR. I WANT TO THANK OF COURSE THE CITY TEAM MR. RADU AND THE GANG, GREAT WORK. AND HOMELESS RESPONSE TEAM. IT'S A TOUGH JOB, YOU SIGNED UP FOR IT, BUT YOU ARE DOING THE BEST YOU CAN, THANK YOU. AUDITOR WONG, THE PENETRATING REPORT AS ALWAYS, THANK YOU. I HAVE A COUPLE OF QUESTIONS AND THEN I WILL GIVE MY POINT OF VIEW HERE. SO ONE I ASKED BEFORE WE LEFT, I AM TRYING TO GET AT THE COST BASIS HERE AND WHAT'S HAPPENING. I READ IN THE REPORT IT SAID FEDERAL FUNDING IS JUST UNDER 30% OF THE DOLLARS WE USE HERE, APPARENTLY, AND SO ADDING IN OR LOOKING AT THE FEDERAL TAX CREDITS THAT PROVIDE THE FINANCING FOR THE BUILDINGS YOU MENTIONED IN YOUR REPORT THE AFFORDABLE HOUSING UNITS AND THE PIPELINE, WHAT WOULD YOU SAY THE FEDERAL TAX COMPONENT IS THAT?

>> STAFF: I THINK HSC DIRECTOR MARGOT ERNST IS PROBABLY IN THE BEST TO TALK ABOUT THE FEDERAL TAX CREDITS AND IMPACTS THAT THEY

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HAVE AND IN LIGHT OF HOW THEY RECENTLY CHANGED.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THERE ARE A LOT OF FOLKS STANDING, SO IF YOU HAVE SEATS NEAR YOU AND YOU CAN MOVE IN TOWARDS THE MIDDLE MORE SO PEOPLE CAN SIT DOWN MORE.

>> ESPECIALLY THE LITTLE KIDS, RIGHT? THE LITTLE KIDS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: HIS LITTLE KID IS HERE, THAT'S WHY HE IS SAYING THAT. GO AHEAD. [INDISCERNIBLE].

>> SO, THERE WE GO. THANK YOU. I AM SORRY, COULD YOU REPEAT THE QUESTION?

>> B. BARTLETT: TRYING TO LOOK AT THE IMPACT OF FEDERAL TAX CREDITS AND OUR SORT OF PLAN OF SOLUTIONS. WE MENTIONED IN THE REPORT THE BUILDING COMING UP AND THE IMPACT OF HOMELESSNESS AND TRYING TO UNDERSTAND THE CHANGE IN TAX CREDITS OR POTENTIAL LOSS OF THEM AND WHAT THAT MEANS.

>> YEAH, SO CERTAINLY AFFORDABLE PROJECTS DO TAKE ADVANTAGE OF THE LOW INCOME HOUSING TAX CREDIT PROGRAM THAT COMES FROM THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT THROUGH THE STATES. OUR LOCAL FUNDS LEVERAGE ABOUT FOUR TO ONE AND THAT INCLUDES TAX CREDITS AND OTHER STATE DOLLARS, SO IT'S NOT JUST TAX CREDITS. THE ONE EXAMPLE THAT I HAVE AVAILABLE RIGHT NOW IS THE MOST RECENT PROJECT THAT WE FINISHED AND I THINK THAT WAS ABOUT 45% FINANCED WITH THE LOW INCOME TAX CREDITS. I DON'T ACTUALLY THINK THERE IS A REDUCTION ON THE HORIZON FOR THOSE FROM WHAT UNDERSTAND. I THINK THAT'S

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ACTUALLY ONE OF THE FEW PROGRAMS THAT IS RECOMMENDED FOR AN INCREASE THROUGH THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT, SO I DON'T SEE THAT BEING REDUCED IN THE -- YOU KNOW, ON THE HORIZON. I THINK SOME OF THE OTHER PROGRAMS THAT WE BENEFIT THROUGH HUD ARE MORE AT RISK.

>> B. BARTLETT: THAT'S GREAT.

>> YEAH, THEY DO. NOT EVERY PROJECT USES THEM, BUT A LOT OF PROJECTS DO.

>> B. BARTLETT: GREAT, THANK YOU. AND THEN I GUESS FOR THE TEAM AS WELL, ARE WE STILL REQUIRED TO IMPLEMENT THE HOUSING FIRST MODEL? WE USED THESE OTHER DOLLARS?

>> STAFF: SO HOUSING FIRST IS CURRENTLY STATE LAW IN CALIFORNIA, AND BERKELEY POLICY AND IN OUR CONTRACTS. YES, COUNCILMEMBER.

>> B. BARTLETT: OKAY. BECAUSE I DO HEAR THAT THAT IS SOMETIMES A BARRIER TO SUCCESSFUL RECUPERATION AND GETTING BACK ON YOUR FEET BECAUSE LETTING PEOPLE WHO ARE TRYING TO GET CLEAN AND OTHERS ARE NOT. THANK YOU THOSE ARE ALL OF MY QUESTIONS. I WANT TO HELP FRAME THE BEST I CAN AFTER YEARS OF WORKING ON THIS. YOU KNOW, IT'S IMPORTANT TO REMEMBER THAT 50 YEARS AGO FOR SOME REASON THE STATE STOPPED BUILDING HOUSING AND STOPPED BUILDING SUPPORTIVE HOUSES, MENTAL HEALTH FACILITIES AND NATIONWIDE IT HAPPENED, TOO. I DON'T KNOW WHAT'S GOING ON HERE WITH THE OLDER

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GENERATION. NOW, WE ARE DOWNSTREAM FROM THE LACK OF INVESTMENT. AND NATIONWIDE HOMELESSNESS IS UP 18%. IT'S NOT JUST HERE. DESPITE ALL OF THIS, BERKELEY HAS INVESTED TIME, ENERGY AND RESOURCES, AND WE HAVE ACHIEVED GREAT RESULTS. WE HAVE A 45% REDUCTION IN HOMELESSNESS, THE BEST DECREASE IN THE COUNTY. WE HAVE THE LOWEST EVICTION RATE IN THE COUNTY, AND WE HAVE OVER 1,000 AND SOMETHING UNITS IN THE PIPELINE. SO HERE'S THE QUESTION, THOUGH, AND WE GET INTO THE COST NOW, SO THE HOME KEY SITES ACCORDING TO MY CALCULATIONS ARE ABOUT $1300 A ROOM PER MONTH. THAT SEEMS REASONABLE. THAT SEEMS LIKE A REASONABLE NUMBER, BUT THEN THE MOTEL BASE SHELTERS, THE NON-CONGREGATE MOTEL SHELTERS ARE NEARLY $8,000 PER ROOM PER MONTH. NUMBERS LIKE THAT MAKE ME WANT TO QUESTION WHAT'S HAPPENING HERE AND IF WE CAN REALLY SUCCEED. THE ALL HOME PLAN WHICH YOU TALKED ABOUT IN THE PRESENTATION SAYS THAT IN ORDER FOR US TO HOUSE 600 PEOPLE, AND REDUCE OUR HOMELESSNESS BY 75% OVER FIVE YEARS, WOULD TAKE NEARLY $300 MILLION. YOU KNOW, THESE NUMBERS DON'T MAKES SENSE REALLY. I UNDERSTAND, I WENT THROUGH THIS WITH OUR RECENT PROJECT WITH HOUSING. WE ARE PROUD OF IT. WE HAD GREAT SAVINGS ON THE PHYSICAL INFRASTRUCTURE, BUT THE SERVICE PIECE REMAINED AN ATTRACTABLE COST. AND SO I THINK WE NEED TO ACCEPT THE STATUS QUO WILL NOT ALLOW US TO MEET OUR GOALS. THE DOLLARS JUST DON'T ADD UP. SO, YOU KNOW, LOOKING AT NEW MODELS OF

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SERVICE DELIVERY OUTSIDE THE BOX, I THINK IT'S NECESSARY TO GET THESE PEOPLE OFF THE STREET. OTHERWISE, WE ARE BACK HERE IN A YEAR HAVING THE SAME CONVERSATION. THOSE ARE MY THOUGHTS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU SO MUCH. OKAY, ANOTHER GROUP OF FOLKS HAVE JUST COME IN. JUST SO YOU KNOW WE ARE WRAPPING UP OUR PREVIOUS MEETING STILL. I AM ABOUT TO MAKE SOME COMMENTS, AND THEN WHAT THAT MEANS IS THAT WE ARE GOING TO HAVE A BREAK, SO DURING THAT BREAK OUR COUNCILMEMBERS ARE GOING TO GO BACK THERE. WE ARE GOING TO HAVE A MINUTE BECAUSE WE HAVE BEEN HERE FOR TWO HOURS AND THEN WE ARE GOING TO COME BACK AND WE WILL DO OUR ACTUAL MEETING. I KNOW WE HAVE A NUMBER OF CEREMONIAL ITEMS FOR FOLKS THAT ARE HERE FOR BRING YOUR KID TO COUNCIL. I WILL RUN BACK OUT REAL QUICK AND THEN COME BACK TO TALK TO YOU. IF YOU ARE HERE TO BRING YOUR KID TO CAN YOU BELIEVE, COME UP TO THE FRONT WHILE WE ARE TAKING OUR BREAK.

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